

ENGLISH FOR JOINERY, FIT-OUTS, AND CLIENT REVIEWS

Carpentry and Remodeling English

Precise details. Clear agreements.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.



Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For carpenters, remodelers, joinery installers, workshop coordinators, and client-facing project staff.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight practical conversations: clarify a dimension, compare trim samples, resolve conflicting drawings, report concealed-condition concerns, separate extras, coordinate trades, correct a fit claim, and hand over an outstanding part.

01 Confirming openings and measurement references 4

What does 900 millimeters describe? | Identify an unclear measurement reference, correct an assumption, and obtain designer clarification before treating the dimension as usable passage.

02 Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes 13

Two oak samples, different trade-offs | Compare specified material, appearance, profile, and quoted lead time without inventing quality rankings or selecting for the client.

03 Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts 22

Two reveals on revision B | Identify a drawing conflict precisely, preserve revision and location details, and request clarification without choosing a dimension by convenience.

04 Discussing concealed conditions without guessing 31

Staining is not a structural finding | Describe an exposed condition, explain what cannot be seen, and refer a structural concern without diagnosing concealed timber.

05 Separating requested extras from agreed work 40

A bench beyond the skirting scope | Explain the agreed task, clarify an additional request, and discuss a separate quotation without implying approval or completion timing.

06 Coordinating access and other trades 49

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved | Report delivery, room access, review timing, and storage restrictions as separate arrangements when coordinating with other trades.

07 Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging 58

Correcting the claim about drawer D3 | Withdraw an inaccurate overall claim, describe a specific alignment observation, and record follow-up without guessing the remedy.

08 Handing over records and return visits 67

Documents received, one cover outstanding | Confirm supplied documents, record an undelivered part, and distinguish an accepted callback commitment from an unconfirmed return visit.

Communication field notes	3
Answers and explanations	76
Fast-access phrase pages	92
Vocabulary index	94
Sources and publication notes	102

Clarify the detail before it becomes a commitment.

Carpentry conversations connect drawings, materials, people, and site conditions. Precise English identifies the reference behind a dimension, separates observations from diagnoses, and makes clear what is agreed, available, delivered, or still awaiting review.

Name the measurement reference

A number without a reference can be misunderstood. Distinguish an opening dimension, a frame dimension, and usable passage. Ask the designer to resolve an unclear note instead of silently choosing an interpretation.

"The drawing says 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the opening reference."

Compare samples on stated attributes

Material construction, grain, profile, finish, price, and timing are different attributes. Compare only what is known about the actual samples; do not turn one quoted lead time into a universal rule about a material.

"Both match the profile; sample A has pronounced grain and the longer quoted lead time."

Describe the visible condition first

A projecting drawer front and stained subfloor can be described without inventing their cause. Correct inaccurate claims promptly and refer technical assessment to the appropriate person.

"D3 projects at the left edge; I have not assessed the cause or remedy."

Keep dates attached to their purpose

Delivery, access, a review meeting, a callback, and a return visit are separate arrangements. State the owner and status of each instead of compressing them into a single promise.

"Mina will call Friday; the return-visit date is still unconfirmed."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All clients, drawings, materials, dimensions, products, prices, schedules, and site conditions in these cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not structural assessment, building-code compliance, tool operation, demolition, installation, or legal interpretation. Follow actual project documents, manufacturer instructions, site controls, competent assessments, and applicable requirements. The scenarios do not authorize fabrication from conflicting drawings, entry to unreleased areas, concealed-condition work, substitutions, extra work, or changes to warranty terms.

What does 900 millimeters describe?

A Read the situation

Identify an unclear measurement reference, correct an assumption, and obtain designer clarification before treating the dimension as usable passage.

Client Hana and carpenter Ellis review a hall drawing labeled door opening: 900 millimeters. Hana assumes the figure describes clear passage width. The note does not identify a rough or finished opening, and no door has been ordered. Ellis must clarify the ambiguity without inventing a frame allowance or asserting a usable width. Designer Priya can explain which reference the dimension uses. The conversation concerns interpretation and referral, not a construction method or a compliance decision.

PEOPLE / Hana: Client | Ellis: Carpenter

A PRECISE NUMBER CAN STILL CARRY AN UNCLEAR MEANING

A client may reasonably read an opening dimension as the space available to pass through. Acknowledge that interpretation, explain the missing reference in ordinary words, and ask the designer to clarify it. Do not make uncertainty sound like a mistake the client should have recognized.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the drawing label say?

- A Finished frame allowance confirmed
- C Clear passage guaranteed at 900 millimeters

- B Door opening: 900 millimeters, without a rough or finished reference
- D Door already ordered at a verified size

2. What is Hana assuming?

- A That a door has already arrived
- C That the frame is not required

- B That Priya has clarified the note
- D That 900 millimeters is clear passage width

3. What is the appropriate next step?

- A Certify the opening as compliant
- C Invent a frame allowance

- B Ask Priya to clarify the measurement reference
- D Order a door from the ambiguous note

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

opening dimension

Measurement describing an opening using a stated reference.

IN USE clarify the opening dimension

rough opening

Structural opening before the door assembly and relevant finishes are installed.

IN USE confirm the rough-opening reference

finished opening

Opening measured at the specified completed surfaces.

IN USE identify the finished opening

clear passage

Unobstructed usable space through an opening under the stated conditions.

IN USE confirm the clear passage

door leaf

Moving panel of a door.

IN USE distinguish the door leaf

door frame

Surrounding assembly supporting and locating the door.

IN USE identify the door frame

jamb

Vertical side member of an opening or frame.

IN USE refer to the jamb

head

Upper horizontal member or part of an opening.

IN USE identify the frame head

threshold

Lower part at the base of a doorway.

IN USE refer to the threshold

casing

Trim around a door or window opening.

IN USE identify the casing

architrave

Term commonly used for decorative trim around an opening.

IN USE compare the architrave profile

millimeter

Metric unit equal to one thousandth of a meter.

IN USE state the dimension in millimeters

Precision check

The only established figure is 900 millimeters in an unclear opening note. Rough opening, finished opening, door size, and clear passage are not interchangeable labels. No conversion or allowance is supplied, and no door has been ordered.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

dimension line

Drawing line indicating the extent of a measurement.

IN USE follow the dimension line

reference face

Surface from which a dimension is measured.

IN USE identify the reference face

datum

Stated reference point, line, or level for measurements.

IN USE confirm the datum

nominal size

Designated size that may differ from an actual measured size.

IN USE distinguish nominal size

actual dimension

Measured or specifically defined physical size.

IN USE verify the actual dimension

frame allowance

Space allowed for the specified frame arrangement.

IN USE verify the frame allowance

clearance

Space between components or around an operating part.

IN USE clarify the required clearance

door schedule

Drawing or document listing specified doors and their attributes.

IN USE check the door schedule

drawing note

Written instruction or information on a drawing.

IN USE clarify the drawing note

designer clarification

Explanation from the responsible design professional.

IN USE request designer clarification

order size

Dimensions used to specify a product for purchase.

IN USE confirm the order size

dimension reference

Point, surface, or condition a measurement describes.

IN USE establish the dimension reference

Precision check

Ask what the measurement runs between and what stage of construction it describes. A clarification can resolve the drawing meaning; it does not by itself establish a code-compliance finding. Do not calculate a usable width from an invented frame thickness.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LOCATE THE NOTE

"The hall drawing labels the door opening as 900 millimeters."

NAME THE AMBIGUITY

"The note does not say rough or finished opening."

ASK ABOUT THE REFERENCE

"What surfaces does this dimension run between?"

AVOID INVENTING AN ALLOWANCE

"We do not have a confirmed frame allowance here."

CLARIFY THE ASSUMPTION

"Are you reading that as the clear passage width?"

EXPLAIN THE DISTINCTION

"The opening reference and the usable passage are not necessarily the same."

KEEP THE NUMBER INTACT

"I am not changing the figure of 900 millimeters."

PRESERVE THE ORDER STATUS

"No door has been ordered."

Labels versus establishes

A drawing label states a number but may not establish its precise reference.

Clear

Describes unobstructed space, not merely a named opening size.

Run between

Natural phrasing for the endpoints of a dimension.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REFER THE INTERPRETATION

"Priya can clarify the measurement reference."

DISTINGUISH PRODUCT SIZE

"We should not treat this as the order size yet."

PRESERVE THE CLIENT NEED

"I will explain that your question concerns usable passage."

READ BACK THE QUERY

"Does 900 refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?"

AVOID A USABLE-WIDTH PROMISE

"I cannot confirm 900 millimeters of clear passage from this note."

ASK FOR EXPLICIT WORDING

"Could the clarification identify the opening type?"

AVOID A COMPLIANCE CLAIM

"This conversation does not establish compliance."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"I will request clarification before presenting the dimension as a confirmed usable width."

Not necessarily

Rejects an unsupported equivalence without asserting a specific alternative.

No order yet

Prevents the clarification discussion from sounding like a change to a placed order.

Reference

Names what the number actually measures, rather than questioning arithmetic.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question targets the missing information?

- A** Does 900 millimeters refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?
- B** Why is 900 always the clear passage?
- C** Which door has already been delivered?
- D** How can we omit the frame?

2. Which reassurance is unsupported?

- A** No door is ordered.
- B** Priya can clarify the reference.
- C** You will definitely have 900 millimeters of usable passage.
- D** The note gives a 900-millimeter figure.

3. What should remain unchanged in the query?

- A** A fabricated confirmed order size
- B** A claim that the drawing means finished opening
- C** The stated 900-millimeter figure and the uncertainty about its reference
- D** A guessed frame deduction

4. Which distinction matters for ordering?

- A** Client interpretation automatically authorizes an order.
- B** A precise number removes every need for clarification.
- C** An unclear opening note is not a confirmed door order size.
- D** All opening and door dimensions are identical.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

What does 900 millimeters describe?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

actual dimension / drawing note / designer clarification / reference face / door frame / rough opening / dimension reference / opening dimension / order size / clear passage

- 01 **Hana:** The hall drawing says the door opening is 900 millimeters. That should give us 900 millimeters to walk through, should it not?
- 02 **Ellis:** I see why you read it that way, but the ¹ _____ is unclear. The note does not say whether it describes a rough opening, a finished opening, or something else.
- 03 **Hana:** I was thinking about the space available when the door is open. I am not asking for the width of the door panel itself.
- 04 **Ellis:** Your question is about ² _____. That is an important distinction. I cannot confirm that usable width from this note without knowing the reference behind the figure.
- 05 **Hana:** What does rough opening mean in ordinary language? I have heard the term, but I do not want to assume it means a rough estimate.
- 06 **Ellis:** A ³ _____ is the structural opening before the door assembly and relevant finishes. Rough describes the construction stage here, not an approximate guess at the measurement.
- 07 **Hana:** That helps. So the frame and the completed surfaces can matter to what the figure means, but we do not yet know which surfaces the note uses.
- 08 **Ellis:** Exactly. We need to identify the ⁴ _____ or faces the dimension runs between. I should not invent that information or quietly subtract an allowance.
- 09 **Hana:** Has a door already been ordered using this number? If it has, I would like the office to know that my question concerns the usable space.
- 10 **Ellis:** No door has been ordered. We do not have a confirmed ⁵ _____ from this conversation, so I am not describing a change to an existing purchase.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Hana:** Good. Who can tell us what the designer intended? I would rather get the wording clarified than have us choose whichever interpretation sounds most likely.
- 12 **Ellis:** Priya can provide ⁶ _____. I will send the note and explain that your concern is the usable passage through the hall doorway.
- 13 **Hana:** Please keep the original number in the question. I do not want someone to think I asked to change it before we understand what it describes.
- 14 **Ellis:** I will preserve the ⁷ _____ of 900 millimeters exactly as written. The query will ask what it measures, not propose a different number.
- 15 **Hana:** Would it be sensible to ask whether the number comes from the frame dimensions? I do not want to leave that possible interpretation hidden.
- 16 **Ellis:** We can ask for an explicit reference, including whether the ⁸ _____ is part of it. We should not decide the answer ourselves or assume a particular frame thickness.
- 17 **Hana:** And we should not tell anyone the opening meets a requirement just because there is a clear number on the drawing. That would need its own checking.
- 18 **Ellis:** Correct. Clarifying the ⁹ _____ is not a compliance assessment. We are resolving the language and reference before relying on it as a usable-width statement.
- 19 **Hana:** Please ask Priya to say whether it is rough opening, finished opening, or another reference, and to address my question about the passage when the door is open.
- 20 **Ellis:** I will include all of that. The ¹⁰ _____ of the usable passage remains unverified here. I will not promise 900 millimeters of clear space or place an order on that assumption.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. dimension reference | 2. clear passage | 3. rough opening | 4. reference face | 5. order size | 6. designer clarification | 7. opening dimension | 8. door frame | 9. drawing note | 10. actual dimension

Clarify before naming the usable width

F Say it

Complete the exchange about the hall drawing. Keep the given number, missing reference, unverified passage, and designer referral distinct.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

designer / passage / 900 / finished

Client: "The drawing says ¹ _____ millimeters."

Carpenter: "The note does not identify rough or ² _____ opening."

Client: "My concern is the clear ³ _____."

Carpenter: "I will ask the ⁴ _____ to clarify the reference."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. 900 | 2. finished | 3. passage | 4. designer

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

A Read the situation

Compare specified material, appearance, profile, and quoted lead time without inventing quality rankings or selecting for the client.

For a study remodel, carpenter Mei compares two trim samples with client Oliver. Sample A is solid oak with pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a quoted four-day lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected, and no price comparison, durability ranking, or installation date is supplied. Mei must keep the comparison tied to these samples rather than generalize about every solid or veneered product.

PEOPLE / Oliver: Client | Mei: Carpenter

COMPARE ATTRIBUTES WITHOUT SELLING AN UNSUPPORTED CONCLUSION

A client may ask which product is better when the real choice involves several preferences. Compare the known attributes side by side and clarify the selection status. Avoid implying that a shorter quoted lead time means better quality or that a material name establishes every performance characteristic.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which description belongs to sample A?

A Plastic trim, no grain, immediate delivery

B A selected product with a confirmed installation date

C Solid oak, pronounced grain, ten-day quoted lead time

D Oak veneer, uniform appearance, four days

2. What do the samples have in common?

A Both have identical grain appearance

B Both have already been selected

C Both match the requested profile

D Both have the same quoted lead time

3. What remains undecided?

A Which sample to select

B Whether B has the shorter quoted lead time

C Whether A is solid oak

D Whether both match the profile

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

solid oak

Material made from oak wood rather than an oak surface veneer over a core.

IN USE specify solid oak trim

oak veneer

Thin oak layer applied over a supporting material.

IN USE identify the oak veneer

veneered trim

Trim with a veneer surface over a core.

IN USE compare veneered trim

timber

Wood prepared or used for building and joinery.

IN USE specify the timber

trim

Finishing material used at edges, joints, or decorative features.

IN USE compare the trim samples

profile

Cross-sectional shape of a trim piece or molding.

IN USE match the requested profile

grain

Visible pattern associated with the wood's structure.

IN USE compare the grain

pronounced grain

Strongly visible wood pattern.

IN USE describe pronounced grain

uniform appearance

More consistent visual character across the sample.

IN USE describe a uniform appearance

core material

Supporting material beneath a surface layer.

IN USE identify the core material

face veneer

Veneer on the visible face of a product.

IN USE specify the face veneer

edge treatment

Way the edge of a component is finished or covered.

IN USE clarify the edge treatment

Precision check

Sample A has pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B has a more uniform appearance and a four-day quote. Both match the profile. These are sample-specific facts, not universal claims about solid oak and veneered products.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

finish sample

Example showing a proposed surface appearance.

IN USE review the finish sample

sheen

Degree of surface reflectivity.

IN USE compare the sheen

clear finish

Coating that allows underlying material to remain visible.

IN USE specify a clear finish

opaque finish

Coating that hides the underlying material's appearance.

IN USE distinguish an opaque finish

stain

Coloring treatment used to change wood's appearance.

IN USE clarify the stain color

quoted lead time

Supply interval stated in a quotation or proposal.

IN USE compare quoted lead times

selection status

Whether a choice has been made.

IN USE confirm the selection status

material construction

How a product is made up of its constituent materials.

IN USE compare material construction

visual preference

Appearance favored by the client.

IN USE clarify the visual preference

sample approval

Acceptance of a particular reference sample.

IN USE record sample approval

performance claim

Statement about how a product will function or endure.

IN USE avoid an unsupported performance claim

installation date

Scheduled day for fitting work at the site.

IN USE confirm the installation date

Precision check

No prices, durability results, finish specifications, or installation dates are given. A shorter lead time does not establish a lower price or better performance. Comparing options does not mean the client has approved either sample or placed an order.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE COMPARISON

"Both samples match the requested profile."

DESCRIBE B'S CONSTRUCTION

"Sample B is oak-veneered trim."

DESCRIBE B'S APPEARANCE

"B has a more uniform appearance."

STATE B'S TIMING

"B has a quoted four-day lead time."

DESCRIBE A'S CONSTRUCTION

"Sample A is solid oak."

DESCRIBE A'S APPEARANCE

"A has more pronounced grain."

STATE A'S TIMING

"A has a quoted ten-day lead time."

MAKE A BOUNDED COMPARISON

"B has the shorter quoted lead time for these two samples."

More pronounced

Compares the visible grain of these samples without declaring one superior.

More uniform

Describes appearance, not guaranteed consistency of every future piece.

Both

Signals the shared profile rather than identical materials.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A PRICE INFERENCE

"We do not have a price comparison here."

PRESERVE THE SHARED FEATURE

"The profile is not the difference between them."

SEPARATE DISCUSSION AND SELECTION

"Discussing A does not mean you have selected it."

PRESERVE THE DECISION STATUS

"No sample is selected yet."

AVOID A QUALITY RANKING

"The material names alone do not establish which will perform better."

CLARIFY THE PREFERENCE

"Is the more visible grain the appearance you prefer?"

KEEP THE DATE DISTINCTION

"A quoted lead time is not an installation appointment."

SUMMARIZE THE TRADE-OFF

"The known differences are construction, appearance, and quoted lead time."

Quoted

Attributes the timing to the supplied quotation rather than a universal delivery rule.

Better

Needs a stated criterion before it becomes a meaningful comparison.

Selected

A decision status that must not be inferred from a favorable comment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is fully supported?

- A** A is booked for installation in ten days.
- B** A is solid oak with pronounced grain and ten days; B is veneered with a more uniform look and four days.
- C** A is cheaper and B is stronger.
- D** B always lasts longer than solid oak.

2. Which attribute does not distinguish the samples?

- A** The requested profile, which both match
- B** Solid versus veneered construction
- C** Pronounced versus more uniform appearance
- D** Ten versus four quoted days

3. Which statement overgeneralizes?

- A** A is quoted at ten days.
- B** Neither sample is selected.
- C** Veneered trim always arrives in four days.
- D** B is quoted at four days.

4. How should Mei record Oliver's interest in A?

- A** A is under discussion; no selection has been made.
- B** A has been purchased and installed.
- C** Both samples are rejected.
- D** B is approved because it is quicker.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

visual preference / quoted lead time / performance claim / material construction / selection status / installation date / sample approval / pronounced grain / oak veneer / profile

- 01 **Oliver:** I like the shape of both pieces. Is there a practical difference between these two oak samples, or is it mainly the way the surface looks?
- 02 **Mei:** There is a difference in ¹ _____. Sample A is solid oak, while sample B is oak-veneered trim. Both match the profile you requested for the study.
- 03 **Oliver:** The pattern on A seems stronger. That could work with the room, although B looks calmer when I hold it beside the wall color.
- 04 **Mei:** A has ² _____, and B has a more uniform appearance. Those are the visual differences stated for these samples, not a ranking of quality.
- 05 **Oliver:** When you say veneered, do you mean that the oak is the visible surface over another material? I want to describe it correctly when we discuss the choice.
- 06 **Mei:** Yes, ³ _____ refers to that surface layer. I do not have a specification for the supporting material here, so I should not name a core that is not listed.
- 07 **Oliver:** What about timing? I remember one option was quicker, but I cannot remember which quote belonged to which sample or whether those were installation dates.
- 08 **Mei:** The ⁴ _____ is ten days for A and four days for B. Those are supply quotes, not confirmed installation appointments.
- 09 **Oliver:** Then B has the shorter quote by six days. That matters to me, but it does not automatically make it the right choice if I prefer A's appearance.
- 10 **Mei:** Exactly. Your ⁵ _____ and the timing are separate considerations. We can compare them without deciding that one sample is better in every respect.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Oliver:** Are the edges shaped differently? I do not want a quicker option if it changes the profile I asked for around the study.
- 12 **Mei:** Both match the requested ⁶ _____. The known differences here are construction, grain appearance, and quoted lead time, not the shape you specified.
- 13 **Oliver:** Is B less expensive? I know that might seem likely to some people, but I would rather compare an actual figure than make an assumption.
- 14 **Mei:** We do not have a price comparison. I also cannot support a ⁷ _____ about which lasts longer from the information on these two samples.
- 15 **Oliver:** I am leaning toward the stronger grain, but I have not decided. Please do not take that comment as permission to order A before I confirm.
- 16 **Mei:** I will keep the ⁸ _____ open. We can note your interest in A without recording it as an approved sample or a placed order.
- 17 **Oliver:** Good. I want to compare the finish details and prices when those are available, rather than use the lead-time difference to stand in for everything else.
- 18 **Mei:** We can keep those as separate questions before ⁹ _____. Nothing in this discussion establishes a finish specification, a price, or a guarantee about future product performance.
- 19 **Oliver:** For now, the summary is solid oak and stronger grain with ten days for A; oak veneer and a more uniform look with four days for B.
- 20 **Mei:** Correct, and neither quote is an ¹⁰ _____. Both match the profile, no sample is selected, and the other details remain to be confirmed before a decision.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. material construction | 2. pronounced grain | 3. oak veneer | 4. quoted lead time | 5. visual preference | 6. profile | 7. performance claim | 8. selection status | 9. sample approval | 10. installation date

Compare without choosing for the client

F Say it

Complete the sample comparison. Use the stated construction, appearance, lead time, and decision status; do not add prices or durability claims.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

selected / uniform / four / oak

Carpenter: "Sample A is solid ¹ _____."

Client: "B has the more ² _____ appearance."

Carpenter: "B has a quoted ³ _____-day lead time."

Client: "Neither sample is ⁴ _____ yet."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. oak | 2. uniform | 3. four | 4. selected

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two reveals on revision B

A Read the situation

03

Identify a drawing conflict precisely, preserve revision and location details, and request clarification without choosing a dimension by convenience.

Carpenter Arun and coordinator Lena review cabinet drawings before a fabrication-release review due at 14:00. Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal at an end panel. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same panel. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies. Both sheets carry the same revision letter, so the team cannot resolve the discrepancy by assuming one is a later issue. No dimension is authorized through this conversation.

PEOPLE / Arun: Carpenter | Lena: Project coordinator

MAKE A CONFLICT EASY TO ANSWER

A useful clarification request contains both drawing references, their revisions, the exact location, and the conflicting values. Include the review deadline as a coordination fact, not a reason to guess. Shared revision labels do not make incompatible dimensions agree.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What conflict is shown?

A C4 revision B gives 20 millimeters; S2 revision B gives 15 at the same panel

C Both drawings give 20

B C4 gives 15 and S2 gives 20 at different rooms

D One drawing is revision C

2. What is due at 14:00?

A The fabrication-release review

C A confirmed designer reply

B Guaranteed installation completion

D Delivery of all cabinets

3. Who has not yet clarified the dimension?

A The designer

C A fabricator who already approved 15

B A customer who already approved 20

D A supplier who changed the drawings

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

elevation

Drawing view showing a face of an object or building.

IN USE read the cabinet elevation

section

Drawing view representing a cut through an object or assembly.

IN USE compare the section

reveal

Defined visible gap or exposed setback between adjacent components.

IN USE confirm the reveal dimension

end panel

Panel forming or covering an exposed end of cabinetry.

IN USE identify the end panel

revision

Identified issue or update of a drawing or document.

IN USE verify the revision

drawing conflict

Inconsistent information between relevant drawings.

IN USE flag a drawing conflict

dimension discrepancy

Difference between dimensions that should describe the same detail.

IN USE report a dimension discrepancy

fabrication

Manufacture of components or assemblies.

IN USE clarify before fabrication

release review

Review of readiness or permission to issue work for the next stage.

IN USE attend the release review

shop drawing

Detailed production or installation drawing for a specific assembly.

IN USE review the shop drawing

detail reference

Identifier pointing to a particular drawing detail.

IN USE include the detail reference

sheet number

Identifier of a drawing sheet.

IN USE quote the sheet number

Precision check

The difference is five millimeters, but calculating that difference does not identify the correct reveal. Both C4 and S2 are revision B and refer to the same panel. Neither sheet is established as superseded or authoritative over the other.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

revision cloud

Drawing mark identifying an area of change.

IN USE locate the revision cloud

superseded drawing

Earlier drawing replaced by a later authorized issue.

IN USE identify a superseded drawing

design intent

Intended design result communicated through the project information.

IN USE clarify the design intent

request for information

Formal or recorded query seeking missing or unclear project information.

IN USE submit a request for information

clarification response

Reply resolving a stated information question.

IN USE await the clarification response

applicable dimension

Measurement confirmed as relevant to the detail.

IN USE verify the applicable dimension

fabrication release

Authorization or controlled issue allowing production to proceed.

IN USE confirm fabrication release

review deadline

Time by which a review is due.

IN USE state the review deadline

unresolved detail

Information point not yet clarified.

IN USE flag an unresolved detail

cross-reference

Link between related drawing views or documents.

IN USE check the cross-reference

millimeter difference

Difference expressed in the specified metric unit.

IN USE state the millimeter difference

document status

Current issue, approval, or review state of a document.

IN USE preserve the document status

Precision check

14:00 is the fabrication-release review time. It is not an instruction to choose a dimension, a confirmed designer-response time, or evidence that fabrication is released. Refer both values and the precise location through the actual project clarification process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

FLAG THE ISSUE

"I found a conflict at the cabinet end panel."

CITE THE FIRST VIEW

"Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal."

CITE THE SECOND VIEW

"Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters."

CONFIRM THE SHARED LOCATION

"Both dimensions refer to the same end panel."

CHECK THE ISSUE LABELS

"Both sheets are marked revision B."

STATE THE DIFFERENCE

"The values differ by five millimeters."

REJECT A REVISION SHORTCUT

"We cannot identify a newer sheet from those labels alone."

NAME THE MISSING ANSWER

"The designer has not clarified which dimension applies."

At the same panel

Establishes that the two values conflict rather than describe separate locations.

Revision B

A shared issue label, not proof that the content agrees.

Applies

Asks which dimension governs the specific detail.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

REQUEST A DECISION

"Please confirm the applicable reveal dimension."

AVOID A RESPONSE PROMISE

"That review time is not a guaranteed designer-response time."

KEEP BOTH REFERENCES

"I will include C4 and S2 in the query."

ASK FOR AN EXPLICIT RESPONSE

"The reply needs to identify the dimension for this panel."

PRESERVE THE REVIEW TIME

"The fabrication-release review is due at 14:00."

KEEP PRODUCTION STATUS SEPARATE

"The conflict discussion does not authorize fabrication."

AVOID AVERAGING

"I will not use the midpoint as an invented solution."

CLOSE WITH THE CURRENT STATUS

"The detail remains unresolved pending clarification."

Due for review

Describes a planned decision point without implying approval.

Pending clarification

Keeps the question open until a response resolves it.

Five-millimeter difference

Correct arithmetic that does not answer which value is intended.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which query is complete?

- A** At the same end panel, C4 rev B shows 20 mm and S2 rev B shows 15 mm; please clarify for the 14:00 release review.
- B** Please fix the cabinet sometime.
- C** Use 20 because it is larger.
- D** Both sheets agree because they are revision B.

2. Which proposed shortcut is unsupported?

- A** Average the values and fabricate a 17.5-millimeter reveal.
- B** Ask the designer to clarify.
- C** Preserve both revision labels.
- D** Flag the unresolved detail for review.

3. What do the revision labels establish?

- A** S2 is superseded
- B** The reveal is automatically 20
- C** Both sheets are marked B, not which dimension is correct
- D** C4 is definitely newer

4. Which status is accurate at the end?

- A** The designer has approved 15.
- B** The review deadline authorizes 20.
- C** Installation is complete.
- D** The reveal remains unresolved and fabrication is not authorized by this conversation.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Two reveals on revision B

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

clarification response / drawing conflict / review deadline / design intent / unresolved detail / fabrication release / superseded drawing / dimension discrepancy / sheet number / applicable dimension

- 01 **Arun:** Before the release review, I need to flag the end panel on the cabinet drawings. The two views give different reveal dimensions at the same location.
- 02 **Lena:** Which references are involved? I need the ¹ _____ and revision for each view, not just the two measurements, so the query is easy to follow.
- 03 **Arun:** Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters. I have checked that both refer to this same end panel.
- 04 **Lena:** Then the ² _____ is five millimeters at one detail. Has the designer already responded anywhere, or is the applicable value still unconfirmed?
- 05 **Arun:** The designer has not clarified it. I do not want to choose 20 because the elevation is easier to read or 15 because it uses less space.
- 06 **Lena:** Agreed. We need a ³ _____ that identifies which dimension applies. Neither of those reasons is a design decision we can substitute for the missing answer.
- 07 **Arun:** Both sheets say B. Someone asked whether the section might be older, but I cannot support that from the labels we have in front of us.
- 08 **Lena:** We should not call either a ⁴ _____ on that basis. The shared revision letter does not tell us that one view overrides the other.
- 09 **Arun:** The fabrication-release review is due at 14:00. Please include that, because the unresolved panel detail will matter when the team checks readiness.
- 10 **Lena:** I will state the ⁵ _____ precisely. It explains the coordination need, but it does not guarantee a designer response by then or authorize us to guess.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Arun:** Could the query quote both values in the same sentence? If only one appears in the subject line, the other might get lost when it is forwarded.
- 12 **Lena:** Yes. I will describe the ⁶ _____ as C4 revision B, 20 millimeters, versus S2 revision B, 15 millimeters, at the same end panel.
- 13 **Arun:** Good. And please ask for the reveal specifically. We are not asking the designer to recheck every cabinet dimension before answering this one point.
- 14 **Lena:** I will ask for the ⁷ _____ for the reveal at that panel. The request can be specific without pretending the rest of the drawings have been verified.
- 15 **Arun:** What should the review record say if the answer has not arrived? I do not want an empty note to look as though the discrepancy disappeared.
- 16 **Lena:** It should preserve the ⁸ _____. The absence of a reply does not resolve it, and the record should not say either dimension has been approved.
- 17 **Arun:** There was also a suggestion to split the difference. That would produce a number, but it would not tell us what the designer intended.
- 18 **Lena:** Correct. A midpoint is not ⁹ _____. We should not turn 17.5 millimeters into an invented solution simply because it lies between the two drawing values.
- 19 **Arun:** Please send the precise query and carry the unresolved status into the 14:00 review. I will not describe this conversation as permission to fabricate the panel.
- 20 **Lena:** I will keep ¹⁰ _____ separate from the query. Both references, the shared revision, the conflicting reveal, and the review time will remain explicit in the handoff.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. sheet number | 2. dimension discrepancy | 3. clarification response | 4. superseded drawing | 5. review deadline | 6. drawing conflict | 7. applicable dimension | 8. unresolved detail | 9. design intent | 10. fabrication release

Refer the conflicting detail

F Say it

Complete the drawing query using both references and values. Keep the shared revision and the unresolved status intact.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

15 / panel / clarified / C4

Carpenter: "Elevation ¹ _____ revision B shows 20 millimeters."

Coordinator: "Section S2 revision B shows ² _____ millimeters."

Carpenter: "Both refer to the same end ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The designer has not yet ⁴ _____ the applicable dimension."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. C4 | 2. 15 | 3. panel | 4. clarified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Staining is not a structural finding

A Read the situation

Describe an exposed condition, explain what cannot be seen, and refer a structural concern without diagnosing concealed timber.

04

At a laundry remodel, client Theo notices dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway. He asks carpenter Nia whether the joists are rotten. The joists are not visible, and Nia has not assessed structural condition. Project lead Sam can arrange a qualified assessment. Nia must describe the visible staining and the limits of her knowledge without confirming decay, declaring the structure sound, identifying a cause, or promising a repair.

PEOPLE / Theo: Client | Nia: Carpenter

TAKE THE CONCERN SERIOUSLY WITHOUT GUESSING

A worried client may hear uncertainty as evasiveness. Give a concrete observation and explain the visibility limit before naming the assessment route. Neither alarming certainty nor unsupported reassurance helps the client understand what is actually known.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is visible?

- A** A verified leak source
- B** Dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway
- C** Rotten joists confirmed by assessment
- D** Repaired structural members

2. What limits Nia's conclusion?

- A** A completed assessment proves no concern
- B** The client has already supplied a diagnosis
- C** Every concealed member has been inspected
- D** The joists are not visible and structural condition has not been assessed

3. What can Sam arrange?

- A** A finding that the structure is sound
- B** A qualified assessment
- C** A repair already completed
- D** A guaranteed replacement price

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

subfloor

Supporting floor layer beneath the finished floor covering.

IN USE describe the exposed subfloor

joist

Structural member supporting a floor or ceiling over a span.

IN USE refer to the concealed joists

floor covering

Visible finish material laid over the floor base.

IN USE distinguish the floor covering

exposed surface

Area visible after a covering is absent or removed.

IN USE describe the exposed surface

concealed condition

State of material or construction hidden from view.

IN USE refer a concealed-condition concern

dark staining

Visible discoloration with a dark appearance.

IN USE report dark staining

discoloration

Change in the apparent color of a surface.

IN USE describe the discoloration

timber decay

Deterioration of wood through biological action.

IN USE avoid diagnosing timber decay

structural condition

State of components relevant to carrying loads.

IN USE request assessment of structural condition

load-bearing member

Component intended to support structural loads.

IN USE identify the load-bearing member

moisture source

Origin of water or dampness affecting an area.

IN USE investigate the moisture source

water ingress

Entry of water into an area or construction.

IN USE report a concern about water ingress

Precision check

The visible staining is on the exposed subfloor, not on visible joists. Theo raises possible rot as a question. The joists are concealed and structural condition has not been assessed, so neither decay nor structural soundness is established.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

inspection access

Ability to reach or view an area for examination.

IN USE confirm inspection access

visibility limit

Boundary of what can actually be seen.

IN USE explain the visibility limit

qualified assessor

Person competent to examine the relevant condition.

IN USE refer to a qualified assessor

assessment scope

Matters included in a specified examination.

IN USE confirm the assessment scope

site observation

Condition directly noticed at the location.

IN USE record a site observation

unsupported diagnosis

Conclusion about a problem without adequate assessment.

IN USE avoid an unsupported diagnosis

structural finding

Conclusion reached through appropriate structural assessment.

IN USE distinguish a structural finding

repair proposal

Suggested work to address an established issue.

IN USE await a repair proposal

investigation status

Current stage of checking an unresolved concern.

IN USE report the investigation status

laundry doorway

Opening at the entrance to the laundry area.

IN USE locate the laundry doorway

condition report

Record describing an examined or observed state.

IN USE prepare an accurate condition report

referral route

Process for passing a concern to the appropriate person.

IN USE explain the referral route

Precision check

The location and appearance can be recorded without naming a cause. Sam can arrange a qualified assessment, but the dialogue does not authorize opening up construction, select a testing method, or establish a repair scope, price, or timetable.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE OBSERVATION

"I can see dark staining on the exposed subfloor."

LOCATE IT PRECISELY

"It is beside the laundry doorway."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I understand why you are asking about the joists."

STATE THE VISIBILITY LIMIT

"The joists are not visible here."

STATE THE ASSESSMENT LIMIT

"I have not assessed the structural condition."

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"I cannot confirm that the joists are rotten."

AVOID FALSE REASSURANCE

"I cannot declare them sound from this view either."

KEEP CAUSE OPEN

"The cause of the staining has not been established."

Rotten

A diagnosis the client asks about, not a finding the worker can confirm.

Exposed versus concealed

Distinguishes what can be seen from what remains hidden.

Cannot confirm

Limits certainty without asserting that the concern is impossible.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE SURFACES

"The visible subfloor and the concealed joists are different parts."

AVOID A REPAIR PROMISE

"No repair scope or price is established."

USE NEUTRAL WORDING

"Dark staining observed; concealed condition unassessed."

KEEP THE NEXT STEP CLEAR

"The next step is assessment, not a guessed repair."

REFER THE CONCERN

"Sam can arrange a qualified assessment."

PRESERVE THE CLIENT'S QUESTION

"I will include your concern about possible decay."

AVOID AN INVENTED FINDING

"There is no structural finding to report yet."

READ BACK THE RECORD

"Staining beside the laundry doorway, with joists not visible and cause unknown."

Either

Helps balance an unsupported negative conclusion with an unsupported reassurance.

Arrange

Names a next step without claiming it has already happened.

Unassessed

Means no relevant assessment has been made, not that the condition is acceptable.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report separates observation from diagnosis?

- A** The joists are rotten because the subfloor is dark.
- B** The whole floor is structurally sound.
- C** A leak has definitely damaged every joist.
- D** Dark staining is visible on the subfloor; the concealed joists have not been assessed.

2. Which answer to Theo is unsupported?

- A** The joists are not visible.
- B** Structural condition has not been assessed.
- C** Sam can arrange an assessment.
- D** The joists are definitely sound because we cannot see damage.

3. Which location should the referral include?

- A** An invented roof leak location
- B** Every wall in the house
- C** A joist already exposed elsewhere
- D** Beside the laundry doorway

4. What remains unknown?

- A** Whether Theo asked about rot
- B** Whether the joists are concealed
- C** The cause, concealed structural condition, and any required repair
- D** Whether staining is visible

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Staining is not a structural finding

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

referral route / moisture source / qualified assessor / repair proposal / subfloor / visibility limit / dark staining / site observation / investigation status / laundry doorway

- 01 **Theo:** This dark patch beside the laundry doorway worries me. Does it mean the joists underneath are rotten, or can you tell from what is exposed?
- 02 **Nia:** I can see ¹ _____ on the subfloor. I cannot confirm rot in the joists because they are not visible and I have not assessed structural condition.
- 03 **Theo:** I thought the boards we can see might be the structural members themselves. Are we talking about two different parts of the floor?
- 04 **Nia:** Yes. The exposed ² _____ and the joists beneath it are different parts. Seeing a mark on this surface does not establish the condition of the concealed members.
- 05 **Theo:** So the mark is real, but my explanation for it is only a possibility. I would prefer the report to say that clearly.
- 06 **Nia:** I will record the ³ _____ and your question separately. The note can say where the staining is without claiming that a particular cause has been found.
- 07 **Theo:** Could it be from water coming into the laundry area? I am trying to understand the next question, not asking you to guess a repair.
- 08 **Nia:** The ⁴ _____ has not been established. I should not name a leak or another source from this appearance alone.
- 09 **Theo:** Who can assess it properly? I do not want the concern lost because we cannot see the joists during this conversation.
- 10 **Nia:** Sam, the project lead, can arrange a ⁵ _____ to review the concern. I will include the location and the fact that the joists are not visible.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Theo:** Does arranging that assessment mean we already know the floor needs replacing? I am concerned about both the disruption and the cost.
- 12 **Nia:** No ⁶ _____ is established. An assessment request does not mean replacement has been decided, and I do not have a repair price to quote.
- 13 **Theo:** Equally, I suppose you cannot tell me everything is sound simply because you have not seen a damaged joist. They are still hidden.
- 14 **Nia:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ works both ways. I cannot confirm decay, but I cannot use the lack of a visible joist as reassurance that the structure is sound.
- 15 **Theo:** That is clearer than a yes or no. Please make sure the report does not describe the stain as a completed structural inspection.
- 16 **Nia:** I will keep the ⁸ _____ accurate. There is a visible concern and a referral to arrange, not a completed structural inspection or a technical finding.
- 17 **Theo:** Can you read back the location and the unanswered question? I want Sam to understand exactly what prompted me to ask about the floor.
- 18 **Nia:** Dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the ⁹ _____; joists not visible; structural condition not assessed; client asks whether decay may be present.
- 19 **Theo:** That is the question I meant. Please send it to Sam so the assessment can be arranged before anyone gives me a repair conclusion.
- 20 **Nia:** I will follow that ¹⁰ _____. The message will preserve what is seen, what is concealed, and what remains unknown, without adding a repair recommendation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. dark staining | 2. subfloor | 3. site observation | 4. moisture source | 5. qualified assessor | 6. repair proposal | 7. visibility limit | 8. investigation status | 9. laundry doorway | 10. referral route

Describe what is visible

F Say it

Complete the report to the project lead. Keep the observed surface separate from the concealed joists and the unperformed assessment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assessed / assessment / subfloor / visible

Carpenter: "Dark staining is visible on the exposed ¹ _____."

Client: "The joists are not ² _____."

Carpenter: "Structural condition has not been ³ _____."

Client: "Please ask Sam to arrange a qualified ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. subfloor | 2. visible | 3. assessed | 4. assessment

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A bench beyond the skirting scope

A Read the situation

Explain the agreed task, clarify an additional request, and discuss a separate quotation without implying approval or completion timing.

05

At a bedroom remodel, carpenter Jules reviews the scope with client Amara. The agreed work is replacing skirting only. Decorating is excluded. Amara asks for a built-in bench as an extra. Jules can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed. The conversation must distinguish the existing trim work from the requested bench and must not imply that decorating or a free extra is included.

PEOPLE / Amara: Client | Jules: Carpenter

A HELPFUL REFERRAL CAN PRESERVE A FIRM SCOPE LIMIT

An additional request often arises when a client sees the room taking shape. Acknowledge the idea, identify the existing agreement, and offer the actual quotation route. Avoid making the client feel dismissed while also avoiding a casual promise that creates a different expectation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is included in the current scope?

- A** A built-in bench and full decorating
- B** All bedroom furniture
- C** A confirmed bench installation
- D** Replacing bedroom skirting only

2. What is the new request?

- A** A built-in bench
- B** The skirting replacement already agreed
- C** A completed painting inspection
- D** A warranty extension

3. What can Jules arrange?

- A** A separate quotation, with dimensions, price, and date still unagreed
- B** A free bench completed tomorrow
- C** Automatic decorating
- D** A confirmed bench design already approved

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

skirting

Trim along the base of an internal wall, often called baseboard.

IN USE replace the skirting

baseboard

Common North American term for trim at the foot of an internal wall.

IN USE compare baseboard profiles

built-in bench

Fixed seating integrated into a room or fitted assembly.

IN USE request a built-in bench

agreed scope

Work explicitly included in the current agreement.

IN USE confirm the agreed scope

scope exclusion

Work or condition left outside the agreement.

IN USE explain the scope exclusion

decorating

Surface finishing work such as painting or wallpapering.

IN USE distinguish decorating from carpentry

additional work

Task requested beyond the existing scope.

IN USE quote for additional work

separate quotation

Distinct price proposal for specified extra work.

IN USE arrange a separate quotation

bench dimensions

Measurements defining the proposed bench.

IN USE agree the bench dimensions

design brief

Statement of the requirements for a proposed design.

IN USE clarify the design brief

seat height

Vertical position of a seat surface from a stated reference.

IN USE confirm the seat height

seat depth

Front-to-back dimension of a seat surface.

IN USE clarify the seat depth

Precision check

Replacing the bedroom skirting is the only agreed task. The bench is an additional request, and decorating is excluded. A separate quotation can be arranged, but the request itself does not establish bench measurements, an accepted price, or a completion date.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

overall length

Full end-to-end measurement of an item.

IN USE confirm the overall length

finish requirement

Specified surface appearance or treatment.

IN USE clarify the finish requirement

quotation scope

Tasks and terms covered by a price proposal.

IN USE define the quotation scope

variation

Agreed or proposed change to the original work arrangement.

IN USE record a proposed variation

change authorization

Permission to alter the agreed work.

IN USE obtain change authorization

price agreement

Acceptance of a stated cost for defined work.

IN USE confirm the price agreement

completion commitment

Agreed promise about when work will finish.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion commitment

provisional idea

Initial proposal not yet fully defined or agreed.

IN USE record a provisional idea

measurement visit

Attendance to establish relevant dimensions.

IN USE discuss a measurement visit

client approval

Acceptance from the client through the relevant process.

IN USE record client approval

existing contract

Current agreement governing the booked work.

IN USE distinguish the existing contract

scope handoff

Transfer of the task description for further review or quotation.

IN USE make a clear scope handoff

Precision check

Do not convert a sketch, preference, or informal conversation into an agreed design. The case provides no bench dimensions or finish specification. Keep the current task intact while passing the extra request through the actual quotation and approval process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE IDEA

"I understand you would like a built-in bench as well."

STATE THE EXCLUSION

"Decorating is excluded from this booking."

OFFER THE NEXT STEP

"I can arrange a separate quotation."

KEEP PRICE OPEN

"There is no agreed bench price yet."

NAME THE AGREEMENT

"The current scope is replacing the bedroom skirting only."

SEPARATE THE EXTRA

"The bench is additional work, not part of the existing task."

KEEP DIMENSIONS OPEN

"We have not agreed the bench dimensions."

KEEP TIMING OPEN

"No completion date is confirmed for the bench."

Only

Makes the limit of the current skirting scope explicit.

As well

Introduces an addition without proving it is included.

Quote for

Describes pricing a defined proposal rather than authorizing the work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A FREE-EXTRA PROMISE

"I cannot treat the bench as a free addition."

AVOID BUNDLING DECORATING

"A bench request does not add painting to the current scope."

CLARIFY THE PROPOSAL

"We need a defined bench request for the quotation."

SEPARATE ASKING AND APPROVING

"Asking for a quote does not approve the extra work."

PRESERVE EXISTING WORK

"The skirting replacement remains the agreed task."

AVOID DESIGNING BY ASSUMPTION

"I will not put guessed measurements into the handoff."

READ BACK THE REQUEST

"Built-in bench requested; dimensions, price, and timing unresolved."

CLOSE WITH THE ROUTE

"I will pass the bench request for a separate quotation."

Not yet agreed

Preserves the possibility of a later agreement without inventing one now.

Excluded

Applies to decorating in the current booking, not necessarily every future service.

Proposed variation

Identifies a possible change before it becomes an authorized one.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which scope summary is accurate?

- A** The skirting task has been cancelled.
- B** Skirting replacement only; decorating excluded; bench requested separately.
- C** Bench and decorating already included.
- D** All bedroom work is free because the crew is present.

2. Which response is helpful without overpromising?

- A** I can arrange a separate quotation, with dimensions and timing still to be agreed.
- B** I guarantee a bench tomorrow at no charge.
- C** The question itself changes the contract.
- D** I will invent dimensions to speed things up.

3. What does requesting a quote establish?

- A** A final price agreement
- B** A confirmed completion date
- C** Approval of any design
- D** Interest in having the extra work priced, not approval to perform it

4. Which item must remain excluded from the current booking?

- A** Decorating
- B** Skirting replacement
- C** Recording the bench request
- D** Clarifying the existing task

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

A bench beyond the skirting scope

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quotation scope / existing contract / additional work / completion commitment / bench dimensions / Change authorization / separate quotation / scope exclusion / agreed scope / scope handoff

- 01 **Amara:** While you are replacing the skirting, could you build a bench along that bedroom wall too? It would make the room more useful.
- 02 **Jules:** I can pass on the idea, but the ¹ _____ is skirting replacement only. A built-in bench would be a separate item rather than part of the existing task.
- 03 **Amara:** I understand it is more work. I was not sure whether it could simply be added while you are already here with the materials.
- 04 **Jules:** It is ² _____, and we need a defined proposal for it. Being on site does not establish the dimensions, the price, or when it could be completed.
- 05 **Amara:** Could you get it priced, then? I would like to know what is involved before deciding whether to go ahead with the idea.
- 06 **Jules:** I can arrange a ³ _____. Asking for that quote does not mean you have approved the bench or agreed to pay an amount we have not supplied.
- 07 **Amara:** Good. I have not settled how long or deep it should be. Please do not assume the full length of the wall just because I pointed there.
- 08 **Jules:** I will keep the ⁴ _____ unresolved. The handoff will describe a built-in bench request without turning your gesture into a fixed length or depth.
- 09 **Amara:** Would painting be part of it? I know the current job is carpentry, but I want to understand whether the new idea changes the decorating arrangement.
- 10 **Jules:** The current ⁵ _____ remains decorating. The bench request does not add painting to today's agreement, and any proposed finish would need to be stated in its own quotation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Amara:** That is useful. I would rather see exactly what a price includes than have a lower figure that leaves us disagreeing about the finish later.
- 12 **Jules:** A clear ⁶ _____ matters. We should not promise a finish, a design, or a service that has not been defined in the proposal.
- 13 **Amara:** Do you have an idea of when it could be ready? I am interested, but I do not want to make room arrangements around a guessed date.
- 14 **Jules:** No ⁷ _____ has been made for the bench. I cannot give you a confirmed date before the proposed work and arrangements are agreed.
- 15 **Amara:** Understood. Please keep the skirting replacement as the existing job. I do not want this question to sound like I have replaced that task with the bench.
- 16 **Jules:** I will preserve the ⁸ _____ scope. The skirting remains the agreed task, and the bench will be recorded as a separate request for pricing.
- 17 **Amara:** If I like the quote later, I can confirm the details through the normal process. For now, we are only taking the idea to the next stage.
- 18 **Jules:** Correct. ⁹ _____ has not happened in this conversation. I will not describe your interest as approval to start building or to choose measurements for you.
- 19 **Amara:** Please send the request with those open points. I want the bench considered, but I have not agreed dimensions, a price, or a completion date.
- 20 **Jules:** I will make that ¹⁰ _____ clearly. The note will keep the bench proposal separate, preserve the decorating exclusion, and leave the unagreed details open for the quotation process.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. agreed scope | 2. additional work | 3. separate quotation | 4. bench dimensions | 5. scope exclusion | 6. quotation scope | 7. completion commitment | 8. existing contract | 9. Change authorization | 10. scope handoff

Keep an extra request separate

F Say it

Complete the client exchange about the bedroom work. Preserve the original task, excluded decorating, separate quotation, and unresolved bench dimensions.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quotation / excluded / agreed / skirting

Carpenter: "The agreed task is replacing the ¹ _____."

Client: "Decorating remains ² _____."

Carpenter: "I can arrange a separate ³ _____ for the bench."

Client: "The bench dimensions are not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. skirting | 2. excluded | 3. quotation | 4. agreed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

A Read the situation

Report delivery, room access, review timing, and storage restrictions as separate arrangements when coordinating with other trades.

06

Carpenter Ben updates site coordinator Farah on the study joinery. Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning, but the decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, not for material storage. Farah needs a precise status report. Ben must not turn the delivery confirmation into installation access, or the hallway review arrangement into permission to leave delivered joinery there.

PEOPLE / Farah: Site coordinator | Ben: Carpenter

COORDINATE BY PURPOSE, NOT JUST BY PLACE AND TIME

A room can be available for one activity and unavailable for another. State the purpose attached to each arrangement. Trade coordination works best when delivery, access, review, and storage are reported separately, with the unresolved dependency visible.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is confirmed?

- A Joinery delivery for Tuesday morning
- C Hallway material storage

- B Study access for installation
- D Completion of decorating

2. What remains unresolved?

- A Whether the hallway review is at 11:00
- C Whether hallway storage is permitted

- B Whether delivery is Tuesday morning
- D The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access

3. What is the hallway available for?

- A Unrestricted use by every trade
- C All delivered material storage

- B A separate trim review at 11:00, not storage
- D Automatic study installation

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

joinery

Fitted woodwork or related manufactured components for a project.

IN USE coordinate the joinery delivery

delivery slot

Agreed time period for receiving goods.

IN USE confirm the delivery slot

trade coordination

Arrangement of work between different specialist teams.

IN USE improve trade coordination

access release

Confirmation that a defined area is available for the specified work.

IN USE request an access release

decorator

Trade worker responsible for agreed surface finishing work.

IN USE coordinate with the decorator

carpentry access

Permission and readiness to enter an area for carpentry work.

IN USE confirm carpentry access

work area

Location assigned for a particular task.

IN USE identify the work area

trim review

Check or discussion of the specified trim details.

IN USE attend the trim review

storage permission

Authorization to leave materials in a defined location.

IN USE confirm storage permission

material staging

Temporary positioning of materials before use or movement.

IN USE distinguish material staging from a review

site coordinator

Person coordinating site arrangements across people or tasks.

IN USE update the site coordinator

dependency

Condition that another action relies on.

IN USE identify the access dependency

Precision check

Tuesday morning belongs to the confirmed delivery. Study access is not released. The 11:00 hallway arrangement is for a trim review only, and hallway storage is not permitted. These are separate facts, not a single approval for delivery, storage, and installation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

area readiness

Whether a location is prepared for the intended activity.

IN USE confirm area readiness

handover between trades

Transfer of an area or task from one trade to another.

IN USE coordinate the handover between trades

installation access

Availability of an area for fitting work.

IN USE verify installation access

confirmed delivery

Agreed arrival arrangement for goods.

IN USE report the confirmed delivery

unreleased room

Area not yet handed over for the proposed work.

IN USE flag the unreleased room

purpose-specific access

Permission limited to a named activity.

IN USE respect purpose-specific access

hallway

Passage connecting rooms or areas.

IN USE identify the hallway

logistics update

Report on movement, receipt, access, or related arrangements.

IN USE give a logistics update

storage location

Place where materials may be held.

IN USE confirm the storage location

schedule dependency

Arrangement that must be resolved for a later task to proceed.

IN USE report a schedule dependency

status readback

Repetition of key arrangements to check understanding.

IN USE provide a status readback

coordination query

Question seeking clarification of interdependent arrangements.

IN USE raise a coordination query

Precision check

The scenario does not establish a substitute storage location, a new delivery slot, or the time when the decorator will release the study. Report the unresolved dependency to Farah without inventing a workaround or blaming another trade for an unverified delay.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

START WITH DELIVERY

"The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning."

NAME THE DEPENDENCY

"We still need the decorator's access release."

STATE THE REVIEW ARRANGEMENT

"The hallway is available for the trim review at 11:00."

CLARIFY THE PURPOSE

"That access is for a review, not for staging the delivery."

SEPARATE THE ROOM STATUS

"The study has not been released for carpentry access."

AVOID MERGING PERMISSIONS

"Delivery confirmation does not establish installation access."

STATE THE RESTRICTION

"The hallway is not available for material storage."

KEEP AN ALTERNATIVE OPEN

"No alternative storage location is confirmed here."

06

Confirmed for

Attaches a definite arrangement to its specific purpose.

Released for

Refers to authorization or readiness for the named work, not every use of the room.

Available for review

Does not imply permission to store materials in the same location.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID CHANGING THE BOOKING

"I have not changed the delivery slot."

PRESERVE TRADE COORDINATION

"Please keep the access question visible in the coordination update."

READ BACK THE ARRANGEMENTS

"Tuesday delivery, study unreleased, 11:00 hallway review, no hallway storage."

KEEP INSTALLATION SEPARATE

"No installation start is established by this update."

AVOID GUESSING READINESS

"I do not have a confirmed study-release time."

AVOID ASSIGNING BLAME

"I am reporting the release status, not a cause of delay."

ASK FOR CLARIFICATION

"Can you coordinate the unresolved access arrangement?"

CLOSE WITH THE OPEN ITEM

"Study access remains the unresolved dependency."

06

Not for storage

An explicit restriction that must remain in the handoff.

Still need

Flags a dependency without inventing its cause or resolution.

Separate

Prevents one agreed arrangement from silently authorizing another.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status report is accurate?

- A** Hallway storage approved until decorating finishes.
- B** Study installation guaranteed at 11:00.
- C** Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study access unreleased; hallway review at 11:00; no hallway storage.
- D** All rooms ready because delivery is confirmed.

2. Which inference is unsupported?

- A** Study release remains unresolved.
- B** A confirmed delivery means the study is ready for installation.
- C** The hallway review has a stated time.
- D** Storage in the hallway is excluded.

3. What can Farah coordinate next?

- A** The unresolved study-access arrangement
- B** A completed installation already claimed
- C** A storage location assumed without approval
- D** A new delivery time invented by Ben

4. Which hallway statement should be corrected?

- A** The hallway is available for the specified review.
- B** Storage permission is absent.
- C** We can store the joinery there because the trim review is allowed.
- D** The review is at 11:00.

Answers and explanations: page 86.

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Installation access / delivery slot / logistics update / access release / Purpose-specific access / trim review / confirmed delivery / status readback / schedule dependency / storage location

- 01 **Farah:** Can you give me the study joinery update? I have a delivery note and a review time, but I want to know which arrangements are actually confirmed.
- 02 **Ben:** The ¹ _____ is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The study, however, has not been released by the decorator for carpentry access.
- 03 **Farah:** So I should not put the room down as ready just because the supplier is coming. Do we have a release time from the decorator?
- 04 **Ben:** No confirmed ² _____ time is available. I want that dependency kept visible rather than treated as settled in the delivery update.
- 05 **Farah:** What about the hallway at 11:00? I saw that on the notes and wondered whether it gave the crew somewhere to put the joinery temporarily.
- 06 **Ben:** The hallway is available for a ³ _____ at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.
- 07 **Farah:** Thank you. I will not turn the review arrangement into a holding area. Is another place for the materials confirmed in the information you have?
- 08 **Ben:** No alternative ⁴ _____ is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.
- 09 **Farah:** Understood. I need to coordinate the access issue, but I do not want to tell the team you have moved the delivery without an actual arrangement.
- 10 **Ben:** I have not changed the ⁵ _____. Tuesday morning is still the stated slot. The update flags the mismatch without claiming that a replacement plan exists.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Farah:** Is there any basis for saying installation starts immediately after delivery? That is how someone might read a short note if we leave access out.
- 12 **Ben:** No. ⁶ _____ remains unresolved. Delivery, room release, and the start of fitting work should not be compressed into one promise.
- 13 **Farah:** I also want to avoid blaming the decorator. We know the room has not been released, but the note does not tell us why or when that changes.
- 14 **Ben:** That is the right ⁷ _____ to give. I am reporting the current release status, not a reason for it or a claim that another trade has missed a deadline.
- 15 **Farah:** Please give me the four-point summary once more. I will use it when I coordinate with the people responsible for the room and the delivery.
- 16 **Ben:** Here is the ⁸ _____: Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study unreleased; hallway trim review at 11:00; no material storage in the hallway.
- 17 **Farah:** That makes the open question clear. I need to coordinate study access and any related arrangements without treating the hallway review as a solution to everything.
- 18 **Ben:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ is still the study release. No alternative storage, changed delivery slot, or installation start has been established in this update.
- 19 **Farah:** I will carry that into the coordination discussion. The team needs an accurate list of arrangements and restrictions, not a general statement that everything is ready.
- 20 **Ben:** Exactly. ¹⁰ _____ is the key point for the hallway. I will keep the review permission and the storage restriction together whenever I pass the update on.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. delivery slot | 2. access release | 3. trim review | 4. storage location | 5. confirmed delivery | 6. Installation access | 7. logistics update | 8. status readback | 9. schedule dependency | 10. Purpose-specific access

Keep four arrangements separate

F Say it

Complete the coordinator update. Preserve the confirmed delivery, unreleased study, hallway review time, and storage restriction.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

11:00 / storage / released / Tuesday

Carpenter: "Delivery is confirmed for ¹ _____ morning."

Coordinator: "The study has not been ² _____ for carpentry access."

Carpenter: "The hallway trim review is at ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The hallway is not available for material ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. Tuesday | 2. released | 3. 11:00 | 4. storage

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

A Read the situation

Withdraw an inaccurate overall claim, describe a specific alignment observation, and record follow-up without guessing the remedy.

During a wardrobe review, carpenter Luis tells client Priya that all fronts are flush. Priya points out drawer D3: its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. Luis has not assessed the cause or remedy. He must correct his earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up. The conversation does not establish a measured offset, a tolerance failure, a damaged runner, or an agreed repair and completion time.

PEOPLE / Priya: Client | Luis: Carpenter

A DIRECT CORRECTION PROTECTS TRUST

When a client identifies an exception to an overall claim, acknowledge it explicitly. Correct the claim and record the observable detail. Avoid defending the original wording, minimizing the concern without a standard, or promising a repair before the cause has been assessed.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which earlier statement must Luis correct?

- A D3 needs follow-up
- B The cause is unassessed
- C No repair time is agreed
- D All fronts are flush

2. What does Priya identify?

- A Every drawer is broken
- B A confirmed damaged runner
- C A measured five-millimeter offset
- D D3's left edge projects beyond the neighboring front

3. What should Luis do next in the conversation?

- A Correct the claim and record the specific observation for follow-up
- B Deny the visible exception
- C Promise a replacement runner immediately
- D Declare the projection acceptable without assessment

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

flush

Aligned in the same plane at the relevant surfaces.

IN USE check whether the fronts are flush

drawer front

Visible face panel of a drawer.

IN USE identify the drawer front

neighboring front

Adjacent visible face used as a comparison.

IN USE compare the neighboring front

projecting edge

Edge extending beyond a stated reference surface.

IN USE describe the projecting edge

left edge

Left-hand boundary of the identified component.

IN USE locate the left edge

alignment

Relative positioning of components or surfaces.

IN USE review the alignment

offset

Displacement between specified reference positions or surfaces.

IN USE measure the offset

tolerance

Permitted variation under an applicable specification.

IN USE check the applicable tolerance

snag

Item requiring attention during a completion or quality review.

IN USE record a snag

snagging list

Record of items requiring follow-up before agreed closure.

IN USE add to the snagging list

punch list

Common North American term for a list of completion or correction items.

IN USE update the punch list

fit review

Examination of how components align or work together.

IN USE conduct a fit review

Precision check

Luis must withdraw all fronts are flush because D3 provides a specific exception. The observation is a projecting left edge relative to the neighboring front. It does not establish the projection amount, applicable tolerance, underlying cause, or correct remedy.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

appearance review

Examination of visible finish and presentation.

IN USE record an appearance review

drawer runner

Mechanism or support guiding a drawer's movement.

IN USE inspect the drawer runner

hinge

Joint allowing a door or panel to pivot.

IN USE identify the hinge

adjustment

Change to a component's setting or position.

IN USE assess the need for adjustment

remedy

Action intended to correct an established problem.

IN USE assess the appropriate remedy

root cause

Underlying reason for an observed problem.

IN USE investigate the root cause

correction of record

Amendment of an inaccurate earlier statement.

IN USE make a correction of record

specific exception

Identified case that contradicts a general claim.

IN USE acknowledge the specific exception

quality claim

Statement about the condition or standard of work.

IN USE qualify the quality claim

follow-up item

Matter retained for further checking or action.

IN USE record a follow-up item

verification

Check establishing whether a claim or result is accurate.

IN USE complete verification

closeout status

Whether review and required follow-up are complete.

IN USE preserve the closeout status

Precision check

Record the component identifier, side, and comparison surface so follow-up is specific. Do not convert projects into a claim that the drawer is broken, or a possible adjustment into an agreed repair. The item remains open pending the appropriate assessment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CORRECT THE EARLIER STATEMENT

"I need to correct what I said about all the fronts being flush."

NAME THE COMPONENT

"The observation concerns drawer D3."

AVOID A GUESSED MEASUREMENT

"I have not established the amount of the offset."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"The cause has not been assessed."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXCEPTION

"You are right to point out D3."

LOCATE THE EDGE

"Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front."

AVOID A TOLERANCE CLAIM

"I have not checked the applicable tolerance."

KEEP THE REMEDY OPEN

"I have not determined the appropriate remedy."

All

A universal claim contradicted by even one verified exception.

Projects beyond

Describes relative position without supplying a measured amount.

Left edge

Makes the observation more useful than saying the drawer looks wrong.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID BLAMING HARDWARE

"I cannot call the runner defective from this observation alone."

PRESERVE THE COMPARISON

"The neighboring front is the reference in this observation."

AVOID A REPAIR PROMISE

"No repair method or completion time is agreed."

READ BACK THE ITEM

"D3 left edge projects; cause and remedy unassessed."

RECORD THE FOLLOW-UP

"I will add the specific item to the snagging list."

AVOID MINIMIZING

"I will not dismiss it as acceptable without checking."

LIMIT THE FINDING

"This identifies D3, not every drawer in the wardrobe."

CLOSE HONESTLY

"The earlier overall claim is corrected and this item remains open."

Unassessed

Keeps an observation separate from a technical conclusion.

Correct what I said

Directly withdraws an inaccurate statement rather than quietly changing the subject.

Open item

Acknowledgement and recording do not establish that correction is complete.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening corrects the earlier claim?

- A** I said all, but I meant most, so nothing needs changing.
- B** You must be looking at the wrong wardrobe.
- C** The runner is definitely broken.
- D** I need to correct that: D3's left edge is not flush with the neighboring front.

2. Which snag entry is precise?

- A** All drawers broken and replacement approved.
- B** Wardrobe fine; no follow-up.
- C** Five-millimeter failure repaired.
- D** D3 left edge projects beyond neighboring front; cause and remedy unassessed.

3. Which conclusion is unsupported?

- A** D3 needs follow-up.
- B** The left edge projects.
- C** The earlier all-fronts claim needs correction.
- D** A replacement runner is definitely required.

4. What remains open after recording the item?

- A** Whether Luis made the earlier claim
- B** Whether Priya identified D3
- C** Which edge is described
- D** Cause, remedy, and any completion arrangement

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

drawer front / tolerance / follow-up item / root cause / snagging list / offset / closeout status / remedy / quality claim / correction of record

07

- 01 **Priya:** You said all the fronts were flush, but look at D3. The left edge sits forward of the neighboring front, which does not match that description.
- 02 **Luis:** You are right. I need a ¹ _____ here: my statement about all the fronts being flush was too broad. D3 is a specific exception.
- 03 **Priya:** Thank you. I want the exact drawer recorded, because a general note saying check the wardrobe could miss the point when someone comes back.
- 04 **Luis:** I will identify the ² _____ as D3 and state that its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. That preserves the location and comparison.
- 05 **Priya:** Is it an adjustment issue, or is something wrong with the runner? I am asking because I do not know what makes one side project like that.
- 06 **Luis:** I have not assessed the ³ _____. I should not call the runner defective or promise an adjustment before the reason for the position is checked.
- 07 **Priya:** Have you measured how far it projects? I can see the difference, but I do not want a guessed number written down as if it was measured.
- 08 **Luis:** I have not established the ⁴ _____. The record can describe the visible projection without inventing a measurement or claiming a particular amount.
- 09 **Priya:** Then please do not dismiss it as within tolerance yet either. That would sound like a decision made before the relevant detail has been checked.
- 10 **Luis:** Agreed. I have not checked the applicable ⁵ _____. I will not label it acceptable or unacceptable against a limit that has not been assessed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Priya:** What will you put on the follow-up list? I want the issue acknowledged without the note saying every drawer in the wardrobe has the same problem.
- 12 **Luis:** The ⁶ _____ entry will name D3, the left edge, and the neighboring front as the reference. It will not generalize to every drawer.
- 13 **Priya:** And the earlier statement will be corrected, rather than left above the new note? Otherwise someone could read the two entries and think the item is already resolved.
- 14 **Luis:** Yes. The original ⁷ _____ needs correction. I will not leave an unqualified all-fronts statement standing as though this exception had not been identified.
- 15 **Priya:** Can you tell me when it will be put right? I would like to plan, but I understand you have not established what needs doing.
- 16 **Luis:** I do not have an agreed ⁸ _____ or completion time. Recording the concern is the next step, not confirmation of a particular repair or return arrangement.
- 17 **Priya:** Please read the entry back. I want it specific enough for someone else to find the same edge without needing me to repeat this whole conversation.
- 18 **Luis:** The ⁹ _____ is: drawer D3, left edge projects beyond neighboring front; cause and remedy unassessed; earlier claim that all fronts are flush corrected.
- 19 **Priya:** That is accurate. It acknowledges what we can see and leaves the technical explanation open, without turning the issue into a claim that all the work is wrong.
- 20 **Luis:** Correct. The ¹⁰ _____ for D3 remains open. We have corrected the statement and recorded the observation, but we have not completed the assessment or the follow-up work.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. correction of record | 2. drawer front | 3. root cause | 4. offset | 5. tolerance | 6. snagging list | 7. quality claim | 8. remedy | 9. follow-up item | 10. closeout status

Correct and record the exception

F Say it

Complete the review exchange. Correct the universal claim, identify the projecting edge, and leave the cause and remedy unresolved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

left / flush / unassessed / D3

Carpenter: "I need to correct my claim that all fronts are ¹ _____."

Client: "The specific drawer is ² _____."

Carpenter: "Its ³ _____ edge projects beyond the neighboring front."

Client: "The cause and remedy remain ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. flush | 2. D3 | 3. left | 4. unassessed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Documents received, one cover outstanding

A Read the situation

Confirm supplied documents, record an undelivered part, and distinguish an accepted callback commitment from an unconfirmed return visit.

At a cabinet handover, owner Daniel receives the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet from joinery lead Mina. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but has not arrived. Mina accepts responsibility for supplier follow-up and commits to calling Daniel on Friday. No return-visit date is confirmed. Warranty terms remain those in the supplied document; Mina must not invent wider coverage or imply that receiving the documents means every outstanding item is complete.

PEOPLE / Daniel: Owner | Mina: Joinery lead

08

CLOSE COMPLETED ITEMS WITHOUT HIDING THE REMAINDER

A useful handover can acknowledge documents received while retaining an outstanding part and its follow-up. Name the responsible person and the precise commitment. A promise to call is valuable on its own and should not be expanded into a promised visit or changed warranty.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which documents does Daniel receive?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A new verbal warranty replacing the document | B A completed supplier investigation |
| C Cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet | D Only an unrelated product leaflet |

2. What remains outstanding?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A The correct care sheet | B A confirmed Friday installation |
| C A replacement shelf pin cover that is due but not delivered | D All cabinet drawings |

3. What does Mina commit to?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A guaranteed supplier arrival time | B Supplier follow-up and a Friday call, with no confirmed return visit |
| C A Friday return visit and unlimited warranty | D A delivered cover already fitted |

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

handover pack

Collection of documents supplied at a project handover.

IN USE confirm the handover pack

cabinet drawing

Drawing showing the relevant cabinet arrangement or details.

IN USE provide the cabinet drawings

care sheet

Instructions for looking after a specified finish or product.

IN USE supply the correct care sheet

finish identification

Confirmation of the surface treatment a document applies to.

IN USE check finish identification

shelf pin

Small support component used to locate or carry a shelf.

IN USE identify the shelf pin

pin cover

Cover associated with the specified pin or fitting.

IN USE identify the replacement pin cover

replacement part

Component supplied to replace a specified item.

IN USE track the replacement part

outstanding item

Matter not yet completed, delivered, or resolved.

IN USE retain an outstanding item

due delivery

Expected arrival that has not necessarily occurred.

IN USE distinguish due delivery from receipt

supplier follow-up

Contact with the supplier about an unresolved matter.

IN USE accept supplier follow-up

action owner

Person responsible for carrying out a defined next step.

IN USE name the action owner

callback commitment

Promise to make a return call at a stated time.

IN USE confirm the callback commitment

Precision check

The drawings and correct care sheet are received. The replacement cover is not. Mina accepts supplier follow-up and a Friday call, but no visit date is confirmed. Unlike a requested callback, the Friday call is an explicit commitment in this case.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

return visit

Later attendance at the property.

IN USE arrange a return visit

appointment confirmation

Explicit agreement of a visit arrangement.

IN USE await appointment confirmation

warranty document

Written terms describing the applicable warranty.

IN USE refer to the warranty document

coverage

Matters included under the stated warranty terms.

IN USE verify the documented coverage

exclusion

Matter outside the applicable terms or scope.

IN USE check a stated exclusion

document receipt

Confirmation that a document has been received.

IN USE record document receipt

part receipt

Confirmation that a component has physically arrived.

IN USE verify part receipt

fitting status

Whether the relevant part has been installed or fitted.

IN USE confirm fitting status

handover record

Note of documents, completed work, and unresolved items at transfer.

IN USE update the handover record

open-item tracker

Record used to follow unresolved matters to completion.

IN USE update the open-item tracker

commitment boundary

Limit of what has actually been promised.

IN USE preserve the commitment boundary

closure evidence

Information supporting that an item is genuinely complete.

IN USE obtain closure evidence

08

Precision check

Keep warranty wording tied to the supplied document instead of paraphrasing it into a broader promise. Receipt of documents does not prove that the replacement part has arrived, been fitted, or closed. No supplier delivery date or return appointment is supplied.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CONFIRM THE DOCUMENTS

"You have the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet."

STATE RECEIPT ACCURATELY

"It is due, but it has not been delivered."

NAME THE OWNER

"Mina owns that supplier follow-up."

SEPARATE CALL AND VISIT

"Friday is the callback commitment, not a confirmed return visit."

IDENTIFY THE OPEN ITEM

"The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding."

ACCEPT OWNERSHIP

"I will follow up with the supplier."

MAKE THE STATED COMMITMENT

"I will call you on Friday."

KEEP ATTENDANCE OPEN

"The return-visit date is not confirmed."

08

Due versus delivered

Expected arrival and actual receipt are different statuses.

I will call

An explicit commitment, stronger than a request for someone to call.

Friday

Applies to the phone call, not automatically to delivery or site attendance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A DELIVERY PROMISE

"I do not have a confirmed arrival date for the cover."

AVOID WIDER COVERAGE

"I am not adding a new warranty promise verbally."

PRESERVE FITTING STATUS

"I will not record an undelivered part as fitted."

AVOID PREMATURE CLOSURE

"The cover item stays open pending the actual outcome."

USE THE SUPPLIED TERMS

"The warranty remains as stated in the supplied document."

KEEP RECORDS SEPARATE

"Document receipt does not close the outstanding part."

READ BACK THE HANDOVER

"Documents received, cover outstanding, supplier follow-up with Mina, Friday call."

CLOSE WITH A CLEAR BOUNDARY

"The call is committed; delivery and return attendance are not yet confirmed."

08

As stated

Refers back to the supplied warranty wording without changing it.

Outstanding

Keeps the unresolved cover visible after other handover items are complete.

Received versus fitted

Physical arrival and installation are separate stages.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover summary is correct?

- A** Everything delivered and fitted Friday.
- B** No documents received.
- C** Warranty expanded and supplier delivery guaranteed.
- D** Drawings and care sheet received; cover outstanding; Mina follows up and calls Friday; visit unconfirmed.

2. What does Mina's Friday commitment cover?

- A** A new warranty term
- B** A phone call to Daniel
- C** A confirmed installation visit
- D** Guaranteed cover delivery

3. Which warranty statement is appropriate?

- A** Everything is covered forever.
- B** A verbal handover automatically replaces the document.
- C** Every outstanding item is excluded without reading the terms.
- D** The terms remain those in the supplied document.

4. What is insufficient evidence to close the cover item?

- A** Verified actual completion of the relevant follow-up
- B** Confirmation of the actual outcome through the project process
- C** Evidence that the unresolved item has genuinely been addressed
- D** Receipt of the drawings and care sheet alone

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Documents received, one cover outstanding

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

callback commitment / handover pack / part receipt / warranty document / open-item tracker / care sheet / supplier follow-up / handover record / appointment confirmation / commitment boundary

08

- 01 **Daniel:** I have the cabinet drawings and the care sheet. Before we finish the handover, can we confirm what is still open and who is following it up?
- 02 **Mina:** Yes. The ¹ _____ documents are with you, including the correct sheet for the finish. The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.
- 03 **Daniel:** Is the cover already here waiting to be fitted, or are we waiting for it to arrive? I want to record the right stage.
- 04 **Mina:** We are waiting for ² _____. The cover is due, but it has not been delivered. I should not describe it as here or ready to fit.
- 05 **Daniel:** Who will contact the supplier about it? I do not want each person to assume someone else is checking while the item remains open.
- 06 **Mina:** I accept the ³ _____. I will contact the supplier about the cover, and the record should name me as the person responsible.
- 07 **Daniel:** Thank you. When will I hear from you? A clear update time would help even if the delivery arrangement is not settled yet.
- 08 **Mina:** I will call you on Friday. That is my ⁴ _____, so you have a definite contact point rather than an open-ended note to wait for news.
- 09 **Daniel:** Does Friday also mean you will return to fit the cover, or is that only the call? I need to know whether to arrange access.
- 10 **Mina:** It is the call, not ⁵ _____. No return-visit date is confirmed, and I do not have a confirmed arrival date for the part to give you.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Daniel:** All right. I will not keep Friday free for a visit on that basis. Please make that distinction clear if another person reads the handover record.
- 12 **Mina:** I will preserve the ⁶ _____. The entry will show supplier follow-up with Mina and a Friday call, with the return visit still unconfirmed.
- 13 **Daniel:** One other question: does anything you have said today change the warranty? I have the document, but I do not want two different versions of the terms.
- 14 **Mina:** The ⁷ _____ remains the reference. I am not adding broader coverage verbally or changing the terms supplied with your records.
- 15 **Daniel:** Good. I will use that document for the terms and the care sheet for the finish instructions, rather than treat the outstanding cover note as either one.
- 16 **Mina:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ and warranty document have different purposes. Receiving them does not establish that the replacement cover has arrived or been fitted.
- 17 **Daniel:** Could you read the final record back? I want the documents acknowledged without the whole handover being marked complete while the cover is still missing.
- 18 **Mina:** The ⁹ _____ says drawings and correct care sheet received; replacement cover outstanding; supplier follow-up owned by Mina; Friday callback committed; return date unconfirmed.
- 19 **Daniel:** That is clear. Please keep the cover on the open list until its actual outcome is confirmed. The Friday call will give us the next communication point.
- 20 **Mina:** I will retain it in the ¹⁰ _____. We can acknowledge the documents received while keeping the part, its follow-up, and any later attendance arrangement visible.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. handover pack | 2. part receipt | 3. supplier follow-up | 4. callback commitment | 5. appointment confirmation
| 6. commitment boundary | 7. warranty document | 8. care sheet | 9. handover record | 10. open-item tracker

Confirm the promise without expanding it

F Say it

Complete the handover exchange. Distinguish received documents, the undelivered cover, Mina as owner, and the Friday callback.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

delivered / Mina / Friday / received

Owner: "The drawings and correct care sheet are ¹ _____."

Lead: "The replacement cover has not been ² _____."

Owner: "³ _____ owns the supplier follow-up."

Lead: "I will call ⁴ _____; the return visit is not confirmed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. received | 2. delivered | 3. Mina | 4. Friday

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming openings and measurement references

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What does the drawing label say?

B. Door opening: 900 millimeters, without a rough or finished reference

The note supplies a number but does not identify the opening reference.

2. What is Hana assuming?

D. That 900 millimeters is clear passage width

Hana reads the number as usable passage, which has not been established.

3. What is the appropriate next step?

B. Ask Priya to clarify the measurement reference

Priya can clarify the reference; the conversation does not establish an order size or compliance.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which question targets the missing information?

A. Does 900 millimeters refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?

The question asks what the stated dimension describes without assuming an interpretation.

2. Which reassurance is unsupported?

C. You will definitely have 900 millimeters of usable passage.

The note does not establish usable passage, so the reassurance exceeds the evidence.

3. What should remain unchanged in the query?

C. The stated 900-millimeter figure and the uncertainty about its reference

The query preserves the actual figure while asking for its unresolved meaning.

4. Which distinction matters for ordering?

C. An unclear opening note is not a confirmed door order size.

The dimension reference must be clarified before it can support an appropriate product specification.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming openings and measurement references

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. dimension reference. Turn 2. Dimension reference identifies what the 900-millimeter figure measures, which the current note does not make clear.

2. clear passage. Turn 4. Clear passage is the usable unobstructed space Hana wants to understand, not automatically the dimension on the drawing.

3. rough opening. Turn 6. Rough opening refers to the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes, not an approximate estimate of usable width.

4. reference face. Turn 8. Reference face names a surface used for measurement; the drawing note does not identify those surfaces clearly.

5. order size. Turn 10. Order size is not established by the ambiguous note, and no door has been ordered in this case.

6. designer clarification. Turn 12. Designer clarification is the appropriate route for resolving the intended measurement reference without a guessed interpretation.

7. opening dimension. Turn 14. Opening dimension remains the stated 900 millimeters; the query concerns its meaning rather than a requested numerical change.

8. door frame. Turn 16. Door frame is a distinct component whose dimensions must not be silently equated with usable passage or the ambiguous opening note.

9. drawing note. Turn 18. Drawing note needs an explanation of its measurement reference; the clarification conversation is not a compliance assessment.

10. actual dimension. Turn 20. Actual dimension of the usable passage is not verified; the next step is clarification, not a width guarantee or product order.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. 900

Client: "The drawing says 900 millimeters."

The stated figure is 900 millimeters, although its reference is unclear.

2. finished

Carpenter: "The note does not identify rough or finished opening."

Finished is the alternative opening reference the note does not clarify.

3. passage

Client: "My concern is the clear passage."

Passage identifies the usable space Hana wants to understand.

4. designer

Carpenter: "I will ask the designer to clarify the reference."

The designer can clarify the intended reference without the carpenter inventing it.

02 Briefing and language checks

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which description belongs to sample A?

C. Solid oak, pronounced grain, ten-day quoted lead time

Sample A has the specified solid-oak construction, pronounced grain, and ten-day quote.

2. What do the samples have in common?

C. Both match the requested profile

The shared attribute is the requested profile, not construction, appearance, or timing.

3. What remains undecided?

A. Which sample to select

No selection has been made, although the comparison attributes are stated.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which comparison is fully supported?

B. A is solid oak with pronounced grain and ten days; B is veneered with a more uniform look and four days.

The comparison uses the stated construction, appearance, and quoted timing without adding unsupported claims.

2. Which attribute does not distinguish the samples?

A. The requested profile, which both match

Both samples meet the requested profile, so it is their shared attribute.

3. Which statement overgeneralizes?

C. Veneered trim always arrives in four days.

The four-day quote belongs to sample B, not every veneered product.

4. How should Mei record Oliver's interest in A?

A. A is under discussion; no selection has been made.

Interest or discussion alone does not establish selection, purchase, or installation.

02 Conversation answers

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. material construction.** Turn 2. Material construction distinguishes solid oak in A from oak veneer over a supporting material in B.
- 2. pronounced grain.** Turn 4. Pronounced grain describes the stronger visible pattern on sample A without making a quality or durability claim.
- 3. oak veneer.** Turn 6. Oak veneer is the thin oak surface layer over a supporting material; it is not the same construction as solid oak.
- 4. quoted lead time.** Turn 8. Quoted lead time is ten days for A and four for B; these figures do not establish installation appointments.
- 5. visual preference.** Turn 10. Visual preference concerns the appearance Oliver favors and remains one consideration alongside the stated timing and construction.
- 6. profile.** Turn 12. Profile is the cross-sectional shape, which both samples match; it is not a difference between these options.
- 7. performance claim.** Turn 14. Performance claim would assert durability or function not supplied by the sample comparison; material names alone do not establish it.
- 8. selection status.** Turn 16. Selection status remains undecided; Oliver's favorable comment about A is not approval or an order instruction.
- 9. sample approval.** Turn 18. Sample approval has not been given; the missing comparisons and Oliver's final choice remain unresolved.
- 10. installation date.** Turn 20. Installation date is not supplied by either lead-time quote, and no sample selection or fitting appointment is confirmed.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. oak

Carpenter: "Sample A is solid oak."

Oak is the stated solid material used for sample A.

2. uniform

Client: "B has the more uniform appearance."

Uniform describes B relative to the pronounced grain of A.

3. four

Carpenter: "B has a quoted four-day lead time."

Four days is B's quoted supply interval, not an installation date.

4. selected

Client: "Neither sample is selected yet."

No selection has been made despite discussion of both samples.

03 Briefing and language checks

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What conflict is shown?

A. C4 revision B gives 20 millimeters; S2 revision B gives 15 at the same panel

The two revision-B sheets give different reveal values at the same end panel.

2. What is due at 14:00?

A. The fabrication-release review

The supplied time belongs to the review, not a promised answer or completed fabrication.

3. Who has not yet clarified the dimension?

A. The designer

The designer has not resolved which dimension applies.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which query is complete?

A. At the same end panel, C4 rev B shows 20 mm and S2 rev B shows 15 mm; please clarify for the 14:00 release review.

The complete query includes location, both references, conflicting values, and the review time.

2. Which proposed shortcut is unsupported?

A. Average the values and fabricate a 17.5-millimeter reveal.

No authority is given to invent a midpoint or release fabrication from conflicting dimensions.

3. What do the revision labels establish?

C. Both sheets are marked B, not which dimension is correct

The shared letter does not identify precedence or resolve the inconsistent detail.

4. Which status is accurate at the end?

D. The reveal remains unresolved and fabrication is not authorized by this conversation.

No designer clarification or fabrication authorization is supplied during the exchange.

03 Conversation answers

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. sheet number.** Turn 2. Sheet number locates each drawing precisely for the designer's review of the conflict.
- 2. dimension discrepancy.** Turn 4. Dimension discrepancy is 20 versus 15 millimeters at the same end panel, not two unrelated measurements.
- 3. clarification response.** Turn 6. Clarification response must resolve the intended dimension; convenience or drawing readability does not establish the correct value.
- 4. superseded drawing.** Turn 8. Superseded drawing would mean an earlier issue had been replaced; the shared B labels do not establish that status.
- 5. review deadline.** Turn 10. Review deadline is 14:00 for the fabrication-release review, not an agreed designer-response time or automatic production permission.
- 6. drawing conflict.** Turn 12. Drawing conflict keeps both incompatible values and their references visible in the handoff.
- 7. applicable dimension.** Turn 14. Applicable dimension concerns the reveal at this end panel, not every cabinet measurement.
- 8. unresolved detail.** Turn 16. Unresolved detail keeps the unanswered reveal question visible instead of allowing silence to imply that it has been settled.
- 9. design intent.** Turn 18. Design intent requires clarification; averaging the conflicting values invents a result instead of establishing it.
- 10. fabrication release.** Turn 20. Fabrication release is not granted here; the reveal still requires designer clarification.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. C4

Carpenter: "Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters."

C4 is the elevation reference carrying the 20-millimeter reveal.

2. 15

Coordinator: "Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters."

Fifteen millimeters is the conflicting value on section S2.

3. panel

Carpenter: "Both refer to the same end panel."

The shared panel location is why the values conflict.

4. clarified

Coordinator: "The designer has not yet clarified the applicable dimension."

No clarification has resolved the conflict or authorized a dimension.

04 Briefing and language checks

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is visible?

B. Dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway

Only the staining on the exposed subfloor is directly visible.

2. What limits Nia's conclusion?

D. The joists are not visible and structural condition has not been assessed

The concealed joists and lack of structural assessment prevent a supported diagnosis.

3. What can Sam arrange?

B. A qualified assessment

Sam can arrange assessment, but no finding, repair, or price is supplied.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which report separates observation from diagnosis?

D. Dark staining is visible on the subfloor; the concealed joists have not been assessed.

The report states the visible fact and preserves the unassessed concealed condition.

2. Which answer to Theo is unsupported?

D. The joists are definitely sound because we cannot see damage.

Inability to see the joists cannot establish that they are structurally sound.

3. Which location should the referral include?

D. Beside the laundry doorway

The supplied location helps the assessor identify the actual observed area.

4. What remains unknown?

C. The cause, concealed structural condition, and any required repair

No assessment has established the cause, structural condition, or appropriate repair.

04 Conversation answers

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. dark staining. Turn 2. Dark staining is the observed discoloration on the exposed subfloor, not a confirmed finding of decay in concealed joists.

2. subfloor. Turn 4. Subfloor is the visible supporting floor layer in this case, distinct from the concealed joists about which Theo asks.

3. site observation. Turn 6. Site observation preserves the visible staining and its location without turning the client's proposed explanation into a diagnosis.

4. moisture source. Turn 8. Moisture source has not been established; the question about water does not prove where it came from or what it affected.

5. qualified assessor. Turn 10. Qualified assessor is the appropriate person to examine the relevant concern; no completed assessment or finding exists yet.

6. repair proposal. Turn 12. Repair proposal is not established by requesting an assessment; replacement, cost, and disruption have not been determined.

7. visibility limit. Turn 14. Visibility limit prevents both a confirmed decay diagnosis and a claim that concealed structural members are sound.

8. investigation status. Turn 16. Investigation status remains unassessed for structural condition; describing staining is not equivalent to completing an inspection.

9. laundry doorway. Turn 18. Laundry doorway is the specific location of the observation, allowing the referral to identify the relevant area accurately.

10. referral route. Turn 20. Referral route passes the concern to Sam for arranging qualified assessment, without inventing a diagnosis or authorizing a repair.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. subfloor

Carpenter: "Dark staining is visible on the exposed subfloor."

Subfloor is the visible layer carrying the reported staining.

2. visible

Client: "The joists are not visible."

The joists remain concealed, so their condition cannot be judged from this view.

3. assessed

Carpenter: "Structural condition has not been assessed."

No structural assessment has occurred in the supplied case facts.

4. assessment

Client: "Please ask Sam to arrange a qualified assessment."

Assessment is the available next step, not a confirmed diagnosis or repair.

05 Briefing and language checks

Separating requested extras from agreed work

A Briefing checks / page 40

05

1. What is included in the current scope?

D. Replacing bedroom skirting only

The agreed scope is limited to replacing the bedroom skirting.

2. What is the new request?

A. A built-in bench

Amara requests a built-in bench in addition to the existing work.

3. What can Jules arrange?

A. A separate quotation, with dimensions, price, and date still unagreed

The separate quotation route is available, but the bench terms have not been established.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which scope summary is accurate?

B. Skirting replacement only; decorating excluded; bench requested separately.

The summary preserves the existing task, the exclusion, and the separate new request.

2. Which response is helpful without overpromising?

A. I can arrange a separate quotation, with dimensions and timing still to be agreed.

The quotation route acknowledges the request while preserving the unresolved bench details.

3. What does requesting a quote establish?

D. Interest in having the extra work priced, not approval to perform it

A quotation request is not acceptance of terms or authorization of the additional work.

4. Which item must remain excluded from the current booking?

A. Decorating

Decorating is explicitly excluded and is not added by the bench discussion.

05 Conversation answers

Separating requested extras from agreed work

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. agreed scope. Turn 2. Agreed scope is bedroom skirting replacement only; the bench request does not automatically belong to that agreement.

2. additional work. Turn 4. Additional work describes the bench beyond the existing skirting task, even though both would be in the same bedroom.

3. separate quotation. Turn 6. Separate quotation is the available route for pricing the bench request; it is not an accepted price or permission to begin.

4. bench dimensions. Turn 8. Bench dimensions are not agreed; a pointing gesture does not establish length, depth, height, or a final design.

5. scope exclusion. Turn 10. Scope exclusion keeps decorating outside the existing booking; the bench discussion does not silently add painting or other finishing work.

6. quotation scope. Turn 12. Quotation scope identifies what a proposed price covers, including any stated finish requirements, rather than relying on an unstated assumption.

7. completion commitment. Turn 14. Completion commitment for the bench is absent; interest in the idea and a quotation referral do not establish a finish date.

8. existing contract. Turn 16. Existing contract continues to cover the skirting replacement; discussing a bench does not cancel or replace that task.

9. Change authorization. Turn 18. Change authorization has not been given; a future decision would need to establish the additional work through the relevant process.

10. scope handoff. Turn 20. Scope handoff transfers the bench request with its unresolved dimensions, price, and timing while preserving the skirting-only agreement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. skirting

Carpenter: "The agreed task is replacing the skirting."

Skirting replacement is the only work included in the current agreement.

2. excluded

Client: "Decorating remains excluded."

The current booking excludes decorating, even after the bench question.

3. quotation

Carpenter: "I can arrange a separate quotation for the bench."

A quotation can be arranged without approving or pricing the work now.

4. agreed

Client: "The bench dimensions are not yet agreed."

No bench measurements have been established or accepted during the conversation.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Coordinating access and other trades

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is confirmed?

A. Joinery delivery for Tuesday morning

Only the delivery arrangement is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

2. What remains unresolved?

D. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access

Study access is unresolved because the decorator has not released that area.

3. What is the hallway available for?

B. A separate trim review at 11:00, not storage

The hallway permission is specific to the trim review and excludes material storage.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which status report is accurate?

C. Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study access unreleased; hallway review at 11:00; no hallway storage.

The report preserves each arrangement and the specific hallway restriction.

2. Which inference is unsupported?

B. A confirmed delivery means the study is ready for installation.

Delivery and room access are separate arrangements, so one does not prove the other.

3. What can Farah coordinate next?

A. The unresolved study-access arrangement

Farah needs the unresolved access dependency, not an unauthorized substitute arrangement.

4. Which hallway statement should be corrected?

C. We can store the joinery there because the trim review is allowed.

Permission for the review does not authorize material storage in the hallway.

06 Conversation answers

Coordinating access and other trades

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. delivery slot. Turn 2. Delivery slot is Tuesday morning for the joinery; it does not establish room access, storage permission, or installation readiness.

2. access release. Turn 4. Access release for the study has not been given, and no release time is supplied in the case.

3. trim review. Turn 6. Trim review is the specific activity allowed in the hallway at 11:00; it is not a material-storage arrangement.

4. storage location. Turn 8. Storage location is not confirmed elsewhere, and the hallway is explicitly excluded from material storage.

5. confirmed delivery. Turn 10. Confirmed delivery remains Tuesday morning; reporting the access conflict does not itself reschedule the supplier.

6. Installation access. Turn 12. Installation access is unresolved because the study has not been released; a delivered product does not authorize fitting work there.

7. logistics update. Turn 14. Logistics update reports the actual arrangements and unresolved dependency without inventing a cause or blaming another trade.

8. status readback. Turn 16. Status readback repeats delivery, access, review, and storage separately so no permission is lost or expanded in the handoff.

9. schedule dependency. Turn 18. Schedule dependency is the unresolved study access, which remains distinct from the already confirmed delivery and review arrangements.

10. Purpose-specific access. Turn 20. Purpose-specific access limits the hallway arrangement to the trim review; it does not authorize storage or substitute for study access.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. Tuesday

Carpenter: "Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning."

Tuesday morning is the delivery slot, not a confirmed installation start.

2. released

Coordinator: "The study has not been released for carpentry access."

The decorator has not released the study for the intended work.

3. 11:00

Carpenter: "The hallway trim review is at 11:00."

Eleven o'clock is the separate trim-review time supplied in the case.

4. storage

Coordinator: "The hallway is not available for material storage."

Storage is explicitly excluded even though the hallway review is allowed.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Which earlier statement must Luis correct?

D. All fronts are flush

Luis claimed all fronts were flush, which conflicts with the specific visible exception.

2. What does Priya identify?

D. D3's left edge projects beyond the neighboring front

The supplied observation concerns D3's projecting left edge, without a measurement or cause.

3. What should Luis do next in the conversation?

A. Correct the claim and record the specific observation for follow-up

The supported response is an explicit correction and accurate follow-up record, not a guessed remedy.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening corrects the earlier claim?

D. I need to correct that: D3's left edge is not flush with the neighboring front.

The opening explicitly withdraws the inaccurate overall claim and identifies the exception.

2. Which snag entry is precise?

D. D3 left edge projects beyond neighboring front; cause and remedy unassessed.

The entry preserves the component, side, reference surface, and unassessed cause and remedy.

3. Which conclusion is unsupported?

D. A replacement runner is definitely required.

No assessment establishes that the runner caused the projection or needs replacement.

4. What remains open after recording the item?

D. Cause, remedy, and any completion arrangement

Recording the observation does not determine the cause, repair, or completion timing.

07 Conversation answers

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. correction of record. Turn 2. Correction of record explicitly withdraws the inaccurate claim that all fronts are flush in light of the D3 observation.

2. drawer front. Turn 4. Drawer front is D3's visible face, the specific component Priya wants recorded rather than a vague whole-wardrobe concern.

3. root cause. Turn 6. Root cause remains unassessed; the visible projection does not establish a runner defect or another explanation.

4. offset. Turn 8. Offset is the amount of displacement between the fronts; no measured value is supplied by the visible observation alone.

5. tolerance. Turn 10. Tolerance is the permitted variation under the relevant specification; no comparison with that requirement has been completed here.

6. snagging list. Turn 12. Snagging list records the specific D3 item for follow-up; it does not establish that every drawer has the same condition.

7. quality claim. Turn 14. Quality claim that all fronts were flush must be corrected rather than retained as a conflicting statement beside the new observation.

8. remedy. Turn 16. Remedy is the corrective action, which has not been determined; therefore no method or completion time can be promised here.

9. follow-up item. Turn 18. Follow-up item is the precise D3 left-edge projection, with cause and remedy left unassessed for the next review.

10. closeout status. Turn 20. Closeout status remains open for D3 because recording the observation and correcting a statement do not complete the necessary follow-up.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. flush

Carpenter: "I need to correct my claim that all fronts are flush."

Flush was the inaccurate overall claim contradicted by D3's projecting edge.

2. D3

Client: "The specific drawer is D3."

D3 identifies the drawer that needs the recorded follow-up.

3. left

Carpenter: "Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front."

Left identifies the side of the visible projection in the case.

4. unassessed

Client: "The cause and remedy remain unassessed."

Neither cause nor remedy has been determined by the observation alone.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over records and return visits

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which documents does Daniel receive?

C. Cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet

The case confirms delivery of the cabinet drawings and the correct care sheet.

2. What remains outstanding?

C. A replacement shelf pin cover that is due but not delivered

The replacement cover has not arrived, so that item remains open.

3. What does Mina commit to?

B. Supplier follow-up and a Friday call, with no confirmed return visit

Mina owns supplier follow-up and promises the call, not a visit or delivery date.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover summary is correct?

D. Drawings and care sheet received; cover outstanding; Mina follows up and calls Friday; visit unconfirmed.

The summary preserves completed documents, the open part, ownership, call, and unconfirmed visit.

2. What does Mina's Friday commitment cover?

B. A phone call to Daniel

Mina explicitly commits to calling Friday, while delivery and attendance remain unconfirmed.

3. Which warranty statement is appropriate?

D. The terms remain those in the supplied document.

The case authorizes no change to the supplied warranty terms in either direction.

4. What is insufficient evidence to close the cover item?

D. Receipt of the drawings and care sheet alone

Receiving documents does not establish delivery, fitting, or resolution of the replacement cover.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over records and return visits

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. handover pack.** Turn 2. Handover pack includes the cabinet drawings and correct finish care sheet already received; the replacement cover remains a separate open item.
- 2. part receipt.** Turn 4. Part receipt has not occurred because the replacement shelf pin cover is due but has not been delivered.
- 3. supplier follow-up.** Turn 6. Supplier follow-up is Mina's accepted responsibility for the outstanding cover, rather than an unassigned action for someone else.
- 4. callback commitment.** Turn 8. Callback commitment is Mina's explicit promise to call Friday, distinct from a request or a confirmed delivery arrangement.
- 5. appointment confirmation.** Turn 10. Appointment confirmation for a return visit has not been given; Friday identifies the promised call only.
- 6. commitment boundary.** Turn 12. Commitment boundary limits the Friday promise to a call, without expanding it into delivery or physical attendance.
- 7. warranty document.** Turn 14. Warranty document remains the source of the applicable terms; Mina does not add or remove coverage through this handover conversation.
- 8. care sheet.** Turn 16. Care sheet contains the relevant finish-care information and is already received; it is distinct from warranty terms and the open-part record.
- 9. handover record.** Turn 18. Handover record must distinguish received documents from the undelivered cover and preserve Mina's follow-up and Friday-call commitment.
- 10. open-item tracker.** Turn 20. Open-item tracker keeps the replacement cover unresolved until the actual outcome supports closure, rather than closing it because documents were supplied.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. received

Owner: "The drawings and correct care sheet are received."

The case confirms that both documents have reached the owner.

2. delivered

Lead: "The replacement cover has not been delivered."

The cover is due but has not arrived, so it remains outstanding.

3. Mina

Owner: "Mina owns the supplier follow-up."

Mina explicitly accepts responsibility for contacting the supplier about the cover.

4. Friday

Lead: "I will call Friday; the return visit is not confirmed."

Friday is the committed call date, not an agreed return visit.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming openings and measurement references

Locate the note: The hall drawing labels the door opening as 900 millimeters.

Explain the distinction: The opening reference and the usable passage are not necessarily the same.

Preserve the order status: No door has been ordered.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Open the comparison: Both samples match the requested profile.

Describe A's appearance: A has more pronounced grain.

Make a bounded comparison: B has the shorter quoted lead time for these two samples.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Flag the issue: I found a conflict at the cabinet end panel.

Confirm the shared location: Both dimensions refer to the same end panel.

Name the missing answer: The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Name the observation: I can see dark staining on the exposed subfloor.

State the visibility limit: The joists are not visible here.

Keep cause open: The cause of the staining has not been established.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Separating requested extras from agreed work

Acknowledge the idea: I understand you would like a built-in bench as well.

Separate the extra: The bench is additional work, not part of the existing task.

Keep timing open: No completion date is confirmed for the bench.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Coordinating access and other trades

Start with delivery: The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

Avoid merging permissions: Delivery confirmation does not establish installation access.

Keep an alternative open: No alternative storage location is confirmed here.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Correct the earlier statement: I need to correct what I said about all the fronts being flush.

Locate the edge: Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front.

Keep the remedy open: I have not determined the appropriate remedy.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over records and return visits

Confirm the documents: You have the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet.

Accept ownership: I will follow up with the supplier.

Keep attendance open: The return-visit date is not confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

access release	request an access release	50
action owner	name the action owner	68
actual dimension	verify the actual dimension	6
additional work	quote for additional work	41
adjustment	assess the need for adjustment	60
agreed scope	confirm the agreed scope	41
alignment	review the alignment	59
appearance review	record an appearance review	60
applicable dimension	verify the applicable dimension	24
appointment confirmation	await appointment confirmation	69
architrave	compare the architrave profile	5
area readiness	confirm area readiness	51
assessment scope	confirm the assessment scope	33
baseboard	compare baseboard profiles	41
bench dimensions	agree the bench dimensions	41
built-in bench	request a built-in bench	41
cabinet drawing	provide the cabinet drawings	68
callback commitment	confirm the callback commitment	68
care sheet	supply the correct care sheet	68
carpentry access	confirm carpentry access	50
casing	identify the casing	5
change authorization	obtain change authorization	42
clarification response	await the clarification response	24
clear finish	specify a clear finish	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

clear passage	confirm the clear passage	5
clearance	clarify the required clearance	6
client approval	record client approval	42
closeout status	preserve the closeout status	60
closure evidence	obtain closure evidence	69
commitment boundary	preserve the commitment boundary	69
completion commitment	avoid an unsupported completion commitment	42
concealed condition	refer a concealed-condition concern	32
condition report	prepare an accurate condition report	33
confirmed delivery	report the confirmed delivery	51
coordination query	raise a coordination query	51
core material	identify the core material	14
correction of record	make a correction of record	60
coverage	verify the documented coverage	69
cross-reference	check the cross-reference	24
dark staining	report dark staining	32
datum	confirm the datum	6
decorating	distinguish decorating from carpentry	41
decorator	coordinate with the decorator	50
delivery slot	confirm the delivery slot	50
dependency	identify the access dependency	50
design brief	clarify the design brief	41
design intent	clarify the design intent	24
designer clarification	request designer clarification	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

detail reference include the detail reference	23
dimension discrepancy report a dimension discrepancy	23
dimension line follow the dimension line	6
dimension reference establish the dimension reference	6
discoloration describe the discoloration	32
document receipt record document receipt	69
document status preserve the document status	24
door frame identify the door frame	5
door leaf distinguish the door leaf	5
door schedule check the door schedule	6
drawer front identify the drawer front	59
drawer runner inspect the drawer runner	60
drawing conflict flag a drawing conflict	23
drawing note clarify the drawing note	6
due delivery distinguish due delivery from receipt	68
edge treatment clarify the edge treatment	14
elevation read the cabinet elevation	23
end panel identify the end panel	23
exclusion check a stated exclusion	69
existing contract distinguish the existing contract	42
exposed surface describe the exposed surface	32
fabrication clarify before fabrication	23
fabrication release confirm fabrication release	24
face veneer specify the face veneer	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

finish identification	check finish identification	68
finish requirement	clarify the finish requirement	42
finish sample	review the finish sample	15
finished opening	identify the finished opening	5
fit review	conduct a fit review	59
fitting status	confirm fitting status	69
floor covering	distinguish the floor covering	32
flush	check whether the fronts are flush	59
follow-up item	record a follow-up item	60
frame allowance	verify the frame allowance	6
grain	compare the grain	14
hallway	identify the hallway	51
handover between trades	coordinate the handover between trades	51
handover pack	confirm the handover pack	68
handover record	update the handover record	69
head	identify the frame head	5
hinge	identify the hinge	60
inspection access	confirm inspection access	33
installation access	verify installation access	51
installation date	confirm the installation date	15
investigation status	report the investigation status	33
jamb	refer to the jamb	5
joinery	coordinate the joinery delivery	50
joist	refer to the concealed joists	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

laundry doorway locate the laundry doorway	33
left edge locate the left edge	59
load-bearing member identify the load-bearing member	32
logistics update give a logistics update	51
material construction compare material construction	15
material staging distinguish material staging from a review	50
measurement visit discuss a measurement visit	42
millimeter state the dimension in millimeters	5
millimeter difference state the millimeter difference	24
moisture source investigate the moisture source	32
neighboring front compare the neighboring front	59
nominal size distinguish nominal size	6
oak veneer identify the oak veneer	14
offset measure the offset	59
opaque finish distinguish an opaque finish	15
open-item tracker update the open-item tracker	69
opening dimension clarify the opening dimension	5
order size confirm the order size	6
outstanding item retain an outstanding item	68
overall length confirm the overall length	42
part receipt verify part receipt	69
performance claim avoid an unsupported performance claim	15
pin cover identify the replacement pin cover	68
price agreement confirm the price agreement	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

profile match the requested profile	14
projecting edge describe the projecting edge	59
pronounced grain describe pronounced grain	14
provisional idea record a provisional idea	42
punch list update the punch list	59
purpose-specific access respect purpose-specific access	51
qualified assessor refer to a qualified assessor	33
quality claim qualify the quality claim	60
quotation scope define the quotation scope	42
quoted lead time compare quoted lead times	15
reference face identify the reference face	6
referral route explain the referral route	33
release review attend the release review	23
remedy assess the appropriate remedy	60
repair proposal await a repair proposal	33
replacement part track the replacement part	68
request for information submit a request for information	24
return visit arrange a return visit	69
reveal confirm the reveal dimension	23
review deadline state the review deadline	24
revision verify the revision	23
revision cloud locate the revision cloud	24
root cause investigate the root cause	60
rough opening confirm the rough-opening reference	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

sample approval	record sample approval	15
schedule dependency	report a schedule dependency	51
scope exclusion	explain the scope exclusion	41
scope handoff	make a clear scope handoff	42
seat depth	clarify the seat depth	41
seat height	confirm the seat height	41
section	compare the section	23
selection status	confirm the selection status	15
separate quotation	arrange a separate quotation	41
sheen	compare the sheen	15
sheet number	quote the sheet number	23
shelf pin	identify the shelf pin	68
shop drawing	review the shop drawing	23
site coordinator	update the site coordinator	50
site observation	record a site observation	33
skirting	replace the skirting	41
snag	record a snag	59
snagging list	add to the snagging list	59
solid oak	specify solid oak trim	14
specific exception	acknowledge the specific exception	60
stain	clarify the stain color	15
status readback	provide a status readback	51
storage location	confirm the storage location	51
storage permission	confirm storage permission	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

structural condition	request assessment of structural condition	32
structural finding	distinguish a structural finding	33
subfloor	describe the exposed subfloor	32
superseded drawing	identify a superseded drawing	24
supplier follow-up	accept supplier follow-up	68
threshold	refer to the threshold	5
timber	specify the timber	14
timber decay	avoid diagnosing timber decay	32
tolerance	check the applicable tolerance	59
trade coordination	improve trade coordination	50
trim	compare the trim samples	14
trim review	attend the trim review	50
uniform appearance	describe a uniform appearance	14
unreleased room	flag the unreleased room	51
unresolved detail	flag an unresolved detail	24
unsupported diagnosis	avoid an unsupported diagnosis	33
variation	record a proposed variation	42
veneered trim	compare veneered trim	14
verification	complete verification	60
visibility limit	explain the visibility limit	33
visual preference	clarify the visual preference	15
warranty document	refer to the warranty document	69
water ingress	report a concern about water ingress	32
work area	identify the work area	50

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Carpenters.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for reading plans, discussing measurements and materials, installation work, and client communication. No employment forecasts or credential requirements are reproduced. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Architectural Woodwork Institute. AWI 100: Manufacturer / Supplier Responsibility.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for shop drawings, material samples, explicit change requests, and coordinated review. Fictional drawing conflicts and review times are not requirements stated by this source. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Andersen Windows and Doors. Window and Door Glossary.

[Open the original source](#)

Background terminology for openings, frames, trim, and door components. No product-specific dimensions, installation allowances, or compliance claims are transferred to the cases. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Woodworking: Hazards and Solutions.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for respecting trained roles and actual safety controls. The book provides no machine-operation, chemical-use, or concealed-condition assessment procedure. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All clients, drawings, materials, dimensions, products, prices, schedules, and site conditions in these cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not structural assessment, building-code compliance, tool operation, demolition, installation, or legal interpretation. Follow actual project documents, manufacturer instructions, site controls, competent assessments, and applicable requirements. The scenarios do not authorize fabrication from conflicting drawings, entry to unreleased areas, concealed-condition work, substitutions, extra work, or changes to warranty terms.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)